

ENGLISH FOR SALONS AND BARBERSHOPS

Hairdressing and Barbering English

Clear choices. Confident consultations.



Phil Stilwell

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For hairdressers, barbers, salon assistants, receptionists, and salon team leads.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight lessons on consultations, shape, color, bookings, comfort, prices, concerns, and handovers. Three additional conversations explore curly-hair length, clipper guards, and color-assessment records.

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Agree on the feature, not just the name.

A useful consultation turns broad words and reference pictures into a shared understanding of length, shape, time, price, and permission. Clear language also leaves room to pause, assess suitability, or review a result without promising what has not been established.

A photo contains several choices

The client may want the outline but not the length or fringe. Ask which features matter and confirm the agreed plan before treating the whole picture as an instruction.

"The reference is chin-length, but our agreed outline is collarbone-length, with no fringe requested."

Appearance and technique differ

Explain the supplied visible contrast before using a style label. A photo does not establish which method is suitable for the client or how long daily styling will take.

"Photo A keeps visible hair over the sides; photo B exposes skin in its shortest area."

Assessment comes before assurance

A color goal, Friday deadline, or product name does not establish suitability, service duration, or cost. Record the relevant history and explain what remains to be assessed.

"Today is a consultation; the previous home-color product is still unknown."

A preference is not every permission

A retained length or no-spray request can be passed to reception. A future-service request is not a booking, and service consent is not permission for promotional photography.

"The consultation is requested but not booked, and no promotional-photo consent is recorded."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All salons, clients, prices, photographs described in words, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not cutting, chemical services, medical assessment, product testing, or legal requirements. Follow actual professional training, local rules, product instructions, consultation and consent procedures, and emergency arrangements. No example authorizes an unassessed chemical service, continuing through discomfort, or using a client image without the relevant permission.

Keep the ponytail length

A Read the situation

Separate a reference image into chosen and unchosen features, then confirm the agreed length before cutting.

Client Alex shows stylist Ren a photograph of a chin-length bob with a straight fringe. Alex likes the outline but wants enough length for a low ponytail. No cut has started. Through clarification, they agree to discuss a collarbone-length outline rather than copying the chin-length endpoint. Alex confirms that no fringe is requested. Ren must keep the visual reference, practical length requirement, and agreed plan distinct. The conversation does not guarantee that every strand will tie back or authorize other changes not specifically agreed.

PEOPLE / Alex: Client | Ren: Stylist

A PICTURE STARTS THE CONVERSATION

A client may expect a photograph to explain a preference but may not want every feature copied. Ask which part appeals to them, then point out any conflict with a practical requirement. Confirm the plan in ordinary length words before relying on technical style names.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What practical feature matters to Alex?

A Copying every feature of the photo

C A guaranteed chin-length cut today

B A new straight fringe

D Enough retained length for a low ponytail

2. Which endpoint is agreed for the outline discussion?

A An unspecified amount removed

C Chin length copied automatically

B Collarbone length

D Ear length

3. What is the fringe status?

A It is mandatory for every bob

C The photo automatically authorizes it

B No fringe is requested

D It has already been cut

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

consultation

Discussion to establish preferences, suitability, and the proposed service.

IN USE conduct a consultation

reference photo

Image used to communicate an idea, not automatically a complete instruction.

IN USE discuss the reference photo

bob

Short-to-medium haircut family with a defined outline, varying in length and shape.

IN USE clarify the bob outline

outline

Outer visible shape or boundary of the haircut.

IN USE confirm the outline

perimeter

Outer edge defining the haircut's overall length and shape.

IN USE discuss the perimeter

chin length

Length described relative to the chin.

IN USE distinguish chin length

collarbone length

Length described relative to the collarbone.

IN USE confirm collarbone length

retained length

Hair length kept rather than removed.

IN USE preserve retained length

low ponytail

Hair gathered and secured low at the back of the head.

IN USE retain low-ponytail length

fringe

Front hair shaped to fall over or around the forehead; also called bangs.

IN USE clarify the fringe

bangs

Common US term for a fringe.

IN USE explain bangs

straight fringe

Fringe with a visually straight outline across the front.

IN USE identify the straight fringe

Precision check

The photo has a chin-length endpoint and a straight fringe. Alex chooses neither automatically. The agreed outline discussion is collarbone-length, with no fringe requested and retained ponytail length as the practical requirement.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

face-framing

Hair shaped around the face as a distinct design feature.

IN USE discuss face-framing

front length

Length retained in the hair toward the face.

IN USE protect front length

side length

Length of hair at the sides of the head.

IN USE compare side length

back length

Length of hair at the back of the head.

IN USE confirm back length

parting

Line or division where hair is separated; also called a part.

IN USE identify the parting

blunt outline

Perimeter with a visually solid, even edge.

IN USE describe a blunt outline

layers

Hair lengths arranged at different levels within a haircut.

IN USE discuss layers

trim

Removal of a limited amount, which still needs an agreed length.

IN USE clarify the trim

length removal

Amount of hair to be cut off.

IN USE confirm length removal

shrinkage

Shorter visible length when curls recoil from a stretched or wet state.

IN USE allow for visible shrinkage

agreed plan

Service details explicitly confirmed with the client.

IN USE repeat the agreed plan

consent

Permission for the specified action, not every possible variation.

IN USE confirm service consent

Precision check

A trim, a bob, and enough to tie back can mean different things to different people. Use an agreed visible length reference and check the actual hair before making a promise about how every section will behave.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE REFERENCE

"Which features of this photograph do you like?"

IDENTIFY THE VISIBLE ENDPOINT

"The photograph shows a chin-length bob."

NAME THE REQUIREMENT

"Keeping enough length for a low ponytail matters to you."

KEEP THE FRINGE SEPARATE

"The photo has a straight fringe; is that part of your request?"

SEPARATE LENGTH AND SHAPE

"Do you want the outline, the length, or both?"

ASK ABOUT DAILY USE

"Do you need to be able to tie it back?"

PROPOSE THE LONGER OUTLINE

"Shall we discuss a collarbone-length outline instead?"

RECORD THE EXCLUSION

"No fringe is requested."

Reference versus instruction

A reference suggests features; the client must confirm which ones are intended.

At versus off

Length at the collarbone describes the endpoint; an amount off describes removal.

Fringe and bangs

These regional terms can refer to the same front feature.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CONFIRM BEFORE CUTTING

"Let us agree on the length before any cut begins."

CLARIFY FRONT LENGTH

"How much front length do you want retained?"

AVOID AN ABSOLUTE PROMISE

"I cannot promise every strand will tie back from the photo alone."

READ BACK THE PLAN

"Collarbone-length outline, retained ponytail length, no fringe."

AVOID COPYING EVERYTHING

"The photo is a reference, not permission for every feature."

CHECK THE OUTLINE

"Is this the shape you mean?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please stop me if I have misunderstood the priority."

CLOSE THE CONSULTATION POINT

"That is the agreed direction, with no cut started yet."

Enough for

This expresses a practical requirement that needs checking against the actual hair.

Instead

Instead marks the agreed longer endpoint replacing the photo's shorter one.

No cut started

Clarification occurs before the irreversible action, leaving room to correct the plan.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which read-back preserves the agreement?

- A** Copy everything because a photo was shown
- B** Collarbone-length outline, retain ponytail length, no fringe
- C** Chin-length with the photo's fringe
- D** Remove all front length automatically

2. Which feature needs separate consent?

- A** Keeping the collarbone endpoint already discussed
- B** Recording the ponytail priority already stated
- C** Keeping the front length as requested
- D** The straight fringe shown in the photo

3. What does trim fail to specify on its own?

- A** Whether the service includes shampoo
- B** The agreed amount or endpoint of length removal
- C** Whether the client wants any maintenance
- D** Whether all layers must be removed

4. Which promise is unsupported?

- A** No fringe is requested.
- B** Every strand will definitely fit into a ponytail based only on this photo.
- C** No cut has started.
- D** The reference shows a chin-length bob.

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

Keep the ponytail length

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

length removal / retained length / reference photo / collarbone-length / agreed direction / fringe / trim / read back / perimeter / chin-length

- 01 **Alex:** I like the shape in this picture, but I still need to tie my hair back for work. Can we keep that?
- 02 **Ren:** Yes, let's talk through the ¹ _____ first. Is it the shape you like, or the length as well?
- 03 **Alex:** Mostly the shape. Looking at it now, the ends are much higher than mine. Where would they finish on me?
- 04 **Ren:** This one is ² _____. That could conflict with tying it back, so we should discuss a longer version.
- 05 **Alex:** Could it sit around here instead? I'm pointing to my collarbone. I don't want to spend the day pinning loose pieces back.
- 06 **Ren:** A ³ _____ outline is the direction we'll discuss. I'll check your actual front and side lengths before promising what will reach.
- 07 **Alex:** Good. By outline, do you mean the edge around the bottom? That's the part of the picture I like.
- 08 **Ren:** Exactly. The ⁴ _____ gives that outer shape. We can discuss the shape without copying how short the photograph is.
- 09 **Alex:** And please leave out the bit across the forehead. I don't want bangs. Are those the same as a fringe?
- 10 **Ren:** Yes, ⁵ _____ is another word for bangs. I'll make that clear in the notes.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Alex:** Thank you. I usually wear a low ponytail, not a high one. Does that help explain the length I need?
- 12 **Ren:** It does. The ⁶ _____ needs to support how you wear it. A photo alone can't tell me whether every piece will reach.
- 13 **Alex:** I understand. I just don't want you to see the picture and assume I want everything in it.
- 14 **Ren:** No problem. I'll ⁷ _____ the main points: longer outline at the collarbone, keep the ponytail requirement, and no bangs.
- 15 **Alex:** That's right. When people say just a trim, does that tell you how much to remove?
- 16 **Ren:** Not precisely. A ⁸ _____ could mean different amounts to different clients. We still need to agree where the ends should sit.
- 17 **Alex:** Then let's agree on that before you start. I'd rather check the length in the mirror first.
- 18 **Ren:** Certainly. We can confirm the ⁹ _____ before any cutting. Nothing has been cut yet.
- 19 **Alex:** Great. Longer than the picture, enough length to discuss tying it back, and definitely no fringe.
- 20 **Ren:** That's the ¹⁰ _____. I'll check the remaining details with you before we begin.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. reference photo | 2. chin-length | 3. collarbone-length | 4. perimeter | 5. fringe | 6. retained length | 7. read back | 8. trim | 9. length removal | 10. agreed direction

Confirm another reference-photo request

F Say it

A client shows an ear-length reference but agrees to a shoulder-length outline. The client wants front length retained and explicitly declines bangs. No cut has started.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

front / shoulder-length / bangs / started

Stylist: "The agreed outline is ¹ _____."

Client: "Please retain the ² _____ length."

Stylist: "No ³ _____ are requested."

Client: "The cut has not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. shoulder-length | 2. front | 3. bangs | 4. started

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10 in pairs. Stress chin-length, collarbone-length, and no fringe without changing the selected outline.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Read the question about trim and distinguish length retained from length removed.
3. Complete the shoulder-length transfer, check the key, then read it with the shorter reference and longer chosen endpoint clearly contrasted.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Less bulk, not bare sides

A Read the situation

Compare visible features, clarify an everyday styling limit, and distinguish a style label from an agreed result.

Client Morgan wants less fullness at the neckline but no exposed skin at the sides. Barber Dev has two reference photographs. Photo A, labelled low taper, shows visible hair covering the sides. Photo B, labelled skin fade, shows exposed skin at the shortest area of the sides. Morgan spends five minutes styling each morning. Dev compares only these supplied appearances. No cutting method, exact length, or guaranteed maintenance time has been agreed. Morgan prefers the covered-side appearance of A, while keeping the neckline concern separate.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Client | Dev: Barber

COMPARE WHAT BOTH PEOPLE CAN SEE

Style names can vary between shops, images, and clients. Anchor the comparison in visible features rather than insisting that one label settles the request. A daily time limit expresses a preference; it does not prove a proposed style will meet it.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Morgan want at the neckline?

- A An agreed cutting technique
- C Less fullness

- B A guaranteed daily result
- D More exposed skin at the sides

2. Which supplied photo shows covered sides?

- A Neither has been described
- C Photo B

- B Photo A
- D Both show bare sides

3. How much daily styling time does Morgan report?

- A Forty minutes
- C Twenty minutes

- B Five minutes
- D No time limit is mentioned

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fullness

Visual amount of hair or volume in an area.

IN USE reduce neckline fullness

bulk

Perceived density or weight in a section of hair.

IN USE clarify unwanted bulk

neckline

Lower outline of the hair at the back of the neck.

IN USE discuss the neckline

nape

Back portion of the neck near the lower hairline.

IN USE identify the nape

taper

Gradual change in hair length; the intended appearance still needs clarification.

IN USE discuss a taper

low taper

Style label suggesting a low-positioned transition, interpreted with a reference.

IN USE clarify the low taper

fade

Gradual transition between shorter and longer hair lengths.

IN USE compare fade references

skin fade

Fade whose shortest area exposes skin in the supplied reference.

IN USE identify the skin fade

transition

Visible change from one length or appearance to another.

IN USE describe the transition

blend

Visual merging of different hair lengths or areas.

IN USE discuss the blend

exposed skin

Skin visible where the supplied reference has very short hair.

IN USE avoid exposed skin

coverage

Visible hair remaining over an area.

IN USE retain side coverage

Precision check

Photo A and photo B are defined by their supplied appearances. A keeps visible hair over the sides; B exposes skin at the shortest area. Morgan chooses the covered-side appearance, not every feature associated with the label.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

sideburn

Hair extending down in front of the ear.

IN USE clarify sideburn length

crown

Area toward the upper back of the head.

IN USE identify the crown

hairline

Boundary where hair growth meets visible skin.

IN USE describe the hairline

natural texture

Hair's own visible or tactile pattern and behavior.

IN USE discuss natural texture

density

Amount of hair growing within an area.

IN USE assess hair density

strand thickness

Thickness of an individual hair, distinct from overall density.

IN USE distinguish strand thickness

growth pattern

Direction or arrangement in which hair naturally grows.

IN USE discuss the growth pattern

cowlick

Area where growth direction makes hair stand or turn differently.

IN USE identify a cowlick

finish

Final styled appearance following the service.

IN USE compare the finish

styling routine

Usual steps and time used to arrange hair.

IN USE describe the styling routine

upkeep

Ongoing effort or appointments needed to maintain an appearance.

IN USE discuss upkeep

guide comb

Clipper attachment marked with a nominal remaining hair length; numbering depends on the tool.

IN USE check the guide-comb length

Precision check

Hair density concerns the amount of hair in an area; strand thickness concerns individual hairs. Neither a photo nor a style name establishes Morgan's actual hair characteristics, suitable cutting method, or guaranteed daily maintenance time.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE PRIORITY

"You want less fullness at the neckline."

COMPARE THE REFERENCES

"Photo A keeps visible hair over the sides."

CHECK THE LABEL

"When you say taper, is this the appearance you mean?"

ASK ABOUT ROUTINE

"How much time do you usually spend styling it?"

KEEP THE EXCLUSION CLEAR

"You do not want exposed skin at the sides."

DESCRIBE THE CONTRAST

"Photo B exposes skin in its shortest area."

SEPARATE THE AREAS

"Let us discuss the neckline separately from the sides."

RECORD THE TIME LIMIT

"You have about five minutes each morning."

Less versus none

Less fullness does not mean removing all hair from an area.

At versus on

At the neckline identifies a boundary; on the sides identifies a broader area.

Covered versus exposed

These describe the visible difference relevant to this client's preference.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A GUARANTEE

"I cannot promise that routine from the photograph alone."

AVOID TECHNICAL ASSUMPTIONS

"We have not agreed on a cutting method yet."

CLARIFY BULK

"Where does the fullness bother you most?"

READ BACK THE APPEARANCE

"Less neckline fullness, with visible hair covering the sides."

CLARIFY COVERAGE

"Is keeping the sides covered the important feature?"

ASK FOR A VISIBLE COMPARISON

"Which of these side appearances is closer to your preference?"

CHECK THE NATURAL PATTERN

"We still need to assess how your hair grows."

CONFIRM THE BOUNDARY

"Choosing A does not mean copying every detail."

Label versus reference

A style label helps discussion but does not replace an agreed visual description.

Time budget

Five minutes states available effort, not a verified styling outcome.

Separate priorities

Neckline fullness and side coverage can be discussed without treating them as one decision.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is supported?

- A** Every low taper looks identical.
- B** B guarantees five-minute styling.
- C** A authorizes every cutting method.
- D** A shows covered sides; B shows exposed skin at the shortest area.

2. Which clarification best follows less bulk?

- A** Would you like a skin fade around both ears?
- B** Shall I shorten the whole back by the same amount?
- C** Does that mean you want the top shorter too?
- D** Where does the fullness bother you most?

3. What remains unagreed?

- A** Morgan's five-minute routine
- B** The dislike of exposed sides
- C** Photo A's described coverage
- D** The cutting method and exact length

4. Which summary preserves both preferences?

- A** Reduce neckline fullness while retaining visible side coverage.
- B** Expose the sides because the neckline is bulky.
- C** Copy B because both images are short.
- D** Promise no upkeep after choosing A.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

Less bulk, not bare sides

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

bulk / appearance / growth pattern / Exposed skin / coverage / upkeep / neckline / visual comparison / time budget / styling routine

- 01 **Morgan:** The back feels too full around my collar, but I do not want bare sides. I have had that misunderstood before.
- 02 **Dev:** Let us separate the ¹ _____ from the sides. We can compare the visible features in these two pictures before assuming a style name explains everything.
- 03 **Morgan:** The first picture looks closer. The second one is much shorter at the sides than I would feel comfortable wearing.
- 04 **Dev:** In photo A, labelled low taper, there is visible ² _____ over the sides. Photo B has exposed skin in its shortest side area.
- 05 **Morgan:** A looks closer. Please don't take the sides as short as B; it's the fullness at the collar that bothers me.
- 06 **Dev:** Understood. ³ _____ is not part of your request. The neckline concern does not override that boundary, and choosing A does not select every detail.
- 07 **Morgan:** Should I ask for a taper next time, then? I used that word before and got something much shorter.
- 08 **Dev:** It can help, but a ⁴ _____ is clearer here. Pointing out covered sides and the area of unwanted fullness gives us more precise information than the label alone.
- 09 **Morgan:** That makes sense. The fullness bothers me where the hair meets my collar, rather than across the whole back of my head.
- 10 **Dev:** I will record the unwanted ⁵ _____ in that location. We still need to agree on the exact length and assess the actual hair before choosing a method.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Morgan:** I also have only five minutes in the morning. I cannot spend a long time trying to reproduce a photograph every day.
- 12 **Dev:** Your ⁶ _____ is an important part of the discussion. Five minutes is your available time, not something I can guarantee from a reference image.
- 13 **Morgan:** Usually I just comb it into place. I don't have time for a blow-dry before work.
- 14 **Dev:** Certainly. We can discuss ⁷ _____ alongside appearance. The photograph does not show the person's daily routine, products, or how their hair naturally behaves.
- 15 **Morgan:** Could you check how it sits here at the back? This is the bit that never seems to stay down.
- 16 **Dev:** Correct. Your ⁸ _____ and other hair characteristics still matter. We have not established those details by looking at someone else's hairstyle.
- 17 **Morgan:** Let me check the main point: I prefer A's covered sides, and I want less fullness at the neckline near my collar.
- 18 **Dev:** Yes. That is the agreed ⁹ _____ for discussion. It does not yet specify an exact length or technique, and it does not include the exposed side area in B.
- 19 **Morgan:** Yes. Show me how short you mean before we start, especially around the ears.
- 20 **Dev:** We will confirm the remaining details before proceeding. Your five-minute ¹⁰ _____ stays in the consultation, alongside the neckline priority and the clear preference for visible hair over the sides.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. neckline | 2. coverage | 3. Exposed skin | 4. visual comparison | 5. bulk | 6. styling routine | 7. upkeep | 8. growth pattern | 9. appearance | 10. time budget

Compare another pair of references

F Say it

Photo C shows hair covering the sides. Photo D shows exposed skin at the shortest side area. The client chooses C, dislikes fullness at the nape, and has ten minutes for daily styling. No method is agreed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ten / C / nape / method

Barber: "The client prefers photo ¹ _____."

Client: "The unwanted fullness is at the ² _____."

Barber: "The daily time budget is ³ _____ minutes."

Client: "No cutting ⁴ _____ has been agreed."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. C | 2. nape | 3. ten | 4. method

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the photo comparison. Stress covered sides for A and exposed skin for B; keep the neckline request separate.
2. Switch roles and read the five-minute routine exchange without turning the client's time budget into a guarantee.
3. Complete and check the appearance transfer; read the exclusion as clearly as the requested change.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A cool tone by Friday?

A Read the situation

03

Clarify a color goal and previous-product uncertainty while explaining what a consultation has not yet established.

Client Priya wants the cool color tone in a photograph before Friday. Colorist Ellis is conducting a consultation only today. Priya used a home-color product previously but cannot identify it. Suitability, service duration, and cost have not been assessed, and no color appointment is booked. Ellis distinguishes the desired tonal character from the lightness or darkness of the reference. The conversation records the unknown product and the deadline without promising a formula, exact photographic match, or completion by Friday.

PEOPLE / Priya: Client | Ellis: Colorist

TRANSLATE THE GOAL WITHOUT SELLING CERTAINTY

A client may use brighter, lighter, warmer, and fresher interchangeably. Clarify the visible quality they mean before using technical language. A deadline can guide planning, but it cannot replace assessment of the service, product history, time, and cost.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is booked today?

- A** A confirmed product test
- B** A consultation only
- C** A completed color service
- D** A guaranteed Friday transformation

2. Which history detail remains unknown?

- A** The previous home-color product
- B** Whether Priya brought a photo
- C** The requested Friday deadline
- D** The preference for a cool tone

3. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** No color appointment is booked.
- B** The photographed result will be completed by Friday.
- C** The client wants a cool tone.
- D** Cost has not been assessed.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

color consultation

Discussion and assessment before a possible color service.

IN USE book a color consultation

color goal

Desired color appearance, subject to assessment.

IN USE clarify the color goal

level

Relative lightness or darkness of hair color.

IN USE discuss the color level

tone

Color character such as warm or cool, distinct from lightness.

IN USE clarify the tone

cool tone

Tonal family associated with cooler color character.

IN USE identify a cool tone

warm tone

Tonal family associated with warmer color character.

IN USE describe a warm tone

ash

Salon term for a cool tonal direction; naming systems vary.

IN USE discuss an ash tone

golden

Term describing a warm gold tonal character.

IN USE identify golden tones

base color

Main underlying or overall color being discussed.

IN USE clarify the base color

regrowth

Hair grown since a previous color service.

IN USE discuss visible regrowth

color history

Record of previous coloring products and services.

IN USE review color history

home color

Hair-color product applied outside the salon setting.

IN USE identify previous home color

Precision check

Level describes lightness or darkness; tone describes color character. A cool reference tone does not identify a suitable product, establish a formula, or show that the same result can be achieved on Priya's hair by Friday.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

strand test

Assessment on a small hair sample to examine color response; not a skin allergy test.

IN USE review the strand-test result

permanent color

Product category designed for lasting color change.

IN USE distinguish permanent color

demi-permanent color

Color category distinct from permanent and temporary products; details vary.

IN USE clarify demi-permanent color

semi-permanent color

Color category generally intended to fade over washes; details vary.

IN USE discuss semi-permanent color

temporary color

Product category intended for short-lived color effects.

IN USE identify temporary color

lightener

Product category used to lighten hair, requiring professional assessment.

IN USE discuss a lightener service

toner

Product or service used to adjust tonal character.

IN USE clarify a toner service

highlights

Selected areas made visibly lighter than surrounding hair.

IN USE discuss highlights

balayage

Term associated with hand-painted color placement.

IN USE clarify balayage expectations

banding

Visibly distinct bands of color along the hair that need assessment.

IN USE describe the color banding

suitability

Whether a proposed service is appropriate after assessment.

IN USE assess service suitability

service estimate

Provisional statement of expected time or cost.

IN USE provide a service estimate

Precision check

Unknown is a useful, accurate history entry. Do not relabel an unidentified home product as temporary or harmless. Product names, instructions, warnings, professional assessment, and relevant checks must be handled through actual salon procedures.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

CLARIFY THE ATTRACTION

"Is it the cool tone or the lighter level that you like?"

EXPLAIN TONE

"Tone describes the color character, such as warm or cool."

ASK ABOUT HISTORY

"Which home-color product did you use?"

AVOID GUESSING A CATEGORY

"I cannot assume it was temporary color."

EXPLAIN LEVEL

"Level describes how light or dark the color is."

SET TODAY'S SCOPE

"Today is a consultation only."

RECORD UNCERTAINTY

"The previous product is not yet identified."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE DEADLINE

"I understand you would prefer it before Friday."

By versus before

By includes the deadline; before means earlier than it. Neither establishes the salon can meet the request.

Lighter versus cooler

Lighter concerns level, while cooler concerns tonal character.

Not yet

This marks an unfinished assessment rather than a permanent refusal.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

SEPARATE GOAL AND PROMISE

"The photo shows your goal, not a confirmed result."

NAME THE PENDING ASSESSMENT

"Suitability has not yet been assessed."

KEEP TIME PROVISIONAL

"We have not established the service duration."

KEEP PRICE PROVISIONAL

"We have not assessed the cost yet."

CLARIFY BOOKING STATUS

"No color appointment is booked."

AVOID A FORMULA PROMISE

"We have not selected a product or formula."

CONFIRM THE NEXT DISCUSSION

"We need the relevant history before confirming the service plan."

SUMMARIZE ACCURATELY

"Cool-tone goal, unknown previous product, consultation only."

Unknown versus none

Unknown previous product does not mean no previous coloring occurred.

Goal versus result

A desired appearance is not evidence of an achievable exact match.

Estimate versus quote

An estimate is provisional; use the salon's actual terms for confirmed prices.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation distinguishes level and tone?

- A** Level is warmth or coolness; tone is lightness or darkness.
- B** Level is natural color only; tone is artificial color only.
- C** Level and tone are interchangeable names for lightness.
- D** Level is lightness or darkness; tone is color character.

2. Which history entry is accurate?

- A** Previous home-color product not identified.
- B** No previous color used.
- C** Temporary product confirmed.
- D** Permanent product confirmed.

3. Which response handles the deadline accurately?

- A** I understand Friday matters; we have not assessed whether that is achievable.
- B** Friday is guaranteed because you have a photo.
- C** All color goals take the same time.
- D** Consultation means treatment starts today.

4. Which status should reception receive?

- A** Consultation only; no color appointment booked.
- B** Friday color service confirmed.
- C** Exact formula selected and approved.
- D** Price accepted and paid.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

A cool tone by Friday?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

color goal / level / cost / product identity / Suitability / booking status / home color / service duration / color consultation / Tone

- 01 **Priya:** I love the cool color in this picture. I have an event on Friday, and I was hoping I could have it done before then.
- 02 **Ellis:** I understand the timing. Today is a ¹ _____, so we will clarify the goal and the relevant history before confirming what service might be appropriate.
- 03 **Priya:** Is cool the right word? I like that it does not look golden. I am less certain about whether I want it lighter.
- 04 **Ellis:** That helps. ² _____ describes that color character. We can discuss the cool quality separately from how light or dark you want the overall result.
- 05 **Priya:** I see. I like the cool look, but I don't necessarily want to go much lighter than I am now.
- 06 **Ellis:** Exactly. The ³ _____ is the lightness or darkness. The picture gives us a starting point, but those two preferences still need their own discussion.
- 07 **Priya:** I used a color from a shop at home a while ago. I do not remember the name or what type it was.
- 08 **Ellis:** I will record the previous ⁴ _____ as unidentified. We should not assume it was temporary, or say there was no previous color, simply because the name is missing.
- 09 **Priya:** I may have the packaging somewhere. Would the exact name be more useful than my memory of the color on the box?
- 10 **Ellis:** Yes, accurate ⁵ _____ is useful for the assessment. For now, the honest record is that you used a product but cannot identify it.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Priya:** Could you promise it for Friday, or should I make other plans for the event?
- 12 **Ellis:** Correct. ⁶ _____ has not been assessed, and the photograph does not establish how your hair will respond. I cannot promise that exact result or deadline.
- 13 **Priya:** I appreciate knowing that before I plan around it. I also need to understand how much time I would have to set aside.
- 14 **Ellis:** We have not established the ⁷ _____ yet. It depends on the plan after assessment, so I do not want you to treat a guessed length of appointment as confirmed.
- 15 **Priya:** And the price? I have seen very different prices for color services, and I do not know which description applies to my request.
- 16 **Ellis:** The ⁸ _____ has not been assessed either. We need to clarify the proposed service before discussing a meaningful amount, rather than selecting a price from the photograph alone.
- 17 **Priya:** Okay, let's work out the plan first. I'll try to find the old packaging before we talk about booking.
- 18 **Ellis:** I will record your ⁹ _____ and the unknown product history. No product or formula has been selected, and no color appointment is booked.
- 19 **Priya:** Please keep the cool-tone photo with my notes. I don't want the Friday deadline to rush the decision.
- 20 **Ellis:** Exactly. The ¹⁰ _____ remains consultation only. We will keep the deadline, tonal preference, product uncertainty, and pending time and cost assessment separate in the record.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. color consultation | 2. Tone | 3. level | 4. home color | 5. product identity | 6. Suitability | 7. service duration | 8. cost | 9. color goal | 10. booking status

Keep another color request provisional

F Say it

A client requests a warmer tone for a future event. The previous product is unidentified. Today is consultation only, and neither duration nor price is assessed. No future service is booked.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unidentified / consultation / booked / warmer

Colorist: "The requested tonal direction is ¹ _____."

Client: "My previous product remains ² _____."

Colorist: "Today is a ³ _____ only."

Reception: "No future service is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. warmer | 2. unidentified | 3. consultation | 4. booked

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the level-and-tone exchange twice, switching roles. Emphasize lighter versus cooler.
2. Read the history and booking exchange. Keep unidentified product, consultation only, and unassessed time and cost unchanged.
3. Complete and check the transfer; read the requested deadline without making it a promised service date.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The appointment no longer fits

A Read the situation

04

Explain a delay, calculate the earliest ordinary finish, and offer a reschedule without promising a shortened service.

Receptionist Hana tells client Luis that the 2:00 haircut appointment is running twenty minutes late. The usual service duration is forty minutes, while Luis must leave by 2:45. A 2:20 start would ordinarily finish at 3:00, so the appointment no longer fits the departure requirement. A 10:00 appointment tomorrow is available. This fictional salon waives the change fee when its own delay causes this rescheduling. Luis chooses tomorrow at 10:00, and Hana confirms the replacement appointment without keeping today as an active second booking.

PEOPLE / Luis: Client | Hana: Receptionist

AN APOLOGY NEEDS USEFUL INFORMATION

A brief apology works best with a specific delay, its effect on the client, and a workable option. Do not pressure someone to accept a rushed service because they have already arrived. Explain the relevant local fee rule without presenting it as universal.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the revised start based on the stated delay?

A 2:00

B 2:45

C 3:20

D 2:20

2. When would the ordinary forty-minute service finish?

A 3:00

B 2:40

C 2:45

D 3:20

3. Which replacement does Luis choose?

A Both appointments remain active

B An unspecified later day

C Tomorrow at 10:00

D Today at 2:45

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

appointment slot

Specific time reserved for a service.

IN USE confirm the appointment slot

scheduled start

Originally planned beginning time.

IN USE state the scheduled start

delay

Difference between the planned and later expected start.

IN USE explain the delay

revised start

Updated beginning time following a change.

IN USE confirm the revised start

service duration

Amount of time normally allocated to the service.

IN USE state the service duration

estimated finish

Expected ending time based on available information.

IN USE calculate the estimated finish

departure deadline

Latest time the client must leave.

IN USE respect the departure deadline

time conflict

Incompatibility between two timing requirements.

IN USE identify the time conflict

availability

Whether a slot can currently be offered.

IN USE check tomorrow's availability

reschedule

Move an appointment to a different time.

IN USE reschedule the haircut

replacement booking

New appointment taking the place of the original.

IN USE confirm the replacement booking

cancellation

Removal of an appointment from the schedule.

IN USE record the cancellation

Precision check

The delay changes the start, not the service duration. A 2:20 start plus forty minutes gives 3:00, fifteen minutes after the client must leave. Do not imply the ordinary service can simply fit into twenty-five minutes.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

change fee

Charge associated with altering a booking under a stated policy.

IN USE explain the change fee

fee waiver

Decision not to charge an otherwise applicable fee.

IN USE apply the fee waiver

salon-caused delay

Delay originating from the salon's schedule or operations.

IN USE acknowledge the salon-caused delay

late arrival

Client reaching the appointment after its scheduled start.

IN USE distinguish a late arrival

no-show

Failure to attend without the required notice under a local policy.

IN USE clarify the no-show category

notice period

Required advance time for a change under a specified policy.

IN USE explain the notice period

confirmation message

Written or spoken statement of agreed booking details.

IN USE send a confirmation message

booking record

Stored appointment details and status.

IN USE update the booking record

duplicate booking

Two appointments unintentionally active for the same intended service.

IN USE avoid a duplicate booking

waitlist

List of clients seeking a slot if one becomes available.

IN USE explain the waitlist

service allocation

Time assigned to carry out the planned service.

IN USE preserve the service allocation

calendar date

Specific day identified by date, not only a relative term.

IN USE confirm the calendar date

Precision check

This salon waives the change fee because its delay caused the rescheduling. That is a supplied local policy, not a claim about every salon. Confirm the actual date and replacement status when making a real booking.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE DELAY

"I am sorry; your appointment is running twenty minutes late."

ASK ABOUT THE LIMIT

"What time do you need to leave?"

EXPLAIN THE ARITHMETIC

"A 2:20 start would ordinarily finish at 3:00."

AVOID A RUSHED PROMISE

"I cannot promise a shortened service to make it fit."

STATE THE REVISED START

"The revised start is 2:20."

STATE THE ORDINARY DURATION

"We normally allow forty minutes for this service."

NAME THE CONFLICT

"That would be after your 2:45 departure deadline."

OFFER A CONCRETE ALTERNATIVE

"We have 10:00 tomorrow available."

Running late

This describes schedule delay without necessarily blaming the client.

At versus by

At 2:20 gives a start; by 2:45 gives a latest departure.

Duration versus delay

Forty minutes is service time; twenty minutes is the delay.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

EXPLAIN THE LOCAL POLICY

"We waive the change fee when our delay causes this rescheduling."

CONFIRM ACCEPTANCE

"You would like tomorrow at 10:00 instead."

AVOID A DUPLICATE

"Today's slot will not remain as a second active booking."

DOCUMENT THE REASON

"I will record the salon-caused delay."

INVITE THE CHOICE

"Would you like the appointment moved to that slot?"

REPLACE THE ORIGINAL

"I will make this the replacement for today's appointment."

READ BACK DETAILS

"Let us confirm the date, time, and service together."

CLOSE WITH A CHECK

"Please check that the confirmation shows the agreed replacement."

Instead

Tomorrow's slot replaces today's rather than adding a second service.

Waive versus refund

Waiving a fee means not charging it; refunding returns money already paid.

Relative dates

Tomorrow is clear in conversation but a real confirmation should identify the actual date.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** Forty minutes after 2:20 is 2:40.
- B** Starting at 2:20 would ordinarily finish at 3:00, after your departure deadline.
- C** Twenty minutes late means the service lasts twenty minutes.
- D** A 2:20 start guarantees a 2:45 finish.

2. Why is the change fee waived here?

- A** Luis arrived late.
- B** All tomorrow appointments are free.
- C** The salon's delay causes the rescheduling under its stated policy.
- D** Every salon is legally required to waive every fee.

3. Which booking record is correct after acceptance?

- A** Both slots remain active without discussion.
- B** Today is marked completed.
- C** Tomorrow remains unconfirmed despite the read-back.
- D** Tomorrow 10:00 replaces today's appointment.

4. Which response should be avoided?

- A** Tomorrow at 10:00 is available.
- B** The ordinary finish would be 3:00.
- C** We will definitely compress the forty-minute service into twenty-five minutes.
- D** I am sorry about the delay.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

The appointment no longer fits

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

departure deadline / duplicate booking / service duration / availability / replacement booking / revised start / fee waiver / booking record / confirmation message / delay

- 01 **Luis:** I am here for my two o'clock haircut. Before I sit down, I should mention that I have to leave by quarter to three.
- 02 **Hana:** I am sorry, but we have a twenty-minute ¹ _____ today. I want to explain the timing clearly so you can decide whether another appointment would work better.
- 03 **Luis:** Thank you for telling me. Does that mean I would start at twenty past two, or is that when the haircut would be finished?
- 04 **Hana:** Twenty past two is the ² _____. We normally allow forty minutes for this service, so it would not be finished at that point.
- 05 **Luis:** Then I think we have a problem. I cannot move the time I need to leave, and I do not want to be watching the clock throughout.
- 06 **Hana:** I understand. With the usual ³ _____, the ordinary finish would be three o'clock. That is fifteen minutes after you need to leave.
- 07 **Luis:** Could you squeeze it into twenty-five minutes? I really do have to be out by quarter to three.
- 08 **Hana:** I cannot promise a shortened service to meet your ⁴ _____. The straightforward alternative is to move the appointment to a time that allows the normal service allocation.
- 09 **Luis:** What do you have tomorrow? If there is a morning appointment, that would probably be easier than trying to make today work.
- 10 **Hana:** There is ⁵ _____ at ten tomorrow morning. We can discuss moving your haircut to that slot rather than keeping you waiting for a service that conflicts with your schedule.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Luis:** Ten works for me. Would I have to pay a change fee even though the appointment is moving because the salon is behind?
- 12 **Hana:** Under our stated policy, we apply a ⁶ _____ when our delay causes this rescheduling. You will not be charged that change fee for moving this appointment.
- 13 **Luis:** All right, please move it to ten tomorrow. I would prefer that to rushing today or being late for my next commitment.
- 14 **Hana:** I will confirm the ⁷ _____ for tomorrow at ten. Today's appointment will no longer remain as an active second booking for the same service.
- 15 **Luis:** Thanks. Last time I changed an appointment, I got two reminders. Could you check that today is cancelled?
- 16 **Hana:** I will check the ⁸ _____ when making the change. The record should show the agreed replacement and the salon-caused reason for rescheduling.
- 17 **Luis:** Could we read the details back before I go? I want to be certain I have heard the time correctly and that it is still the haircut.
- 18 **Hana:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ should show the actual date for tomorrow, ten o'clock, and the haircut service. We will check those details together.
- 19 **Luis:** Yes, tomorrow at ten for the haircut. I'll check the date on the confirmation before I leave.
- 20 **Hana:** You are welcome, and I am sorry for the disruption. We have avoided a ¹⁰ _____ and agreed on the new slot, with the change fee waived under our policy for this delay.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. delay | 2. revised start | 3. service duration | 4. departure deadline | 5. availability | 6. fee waiver | 7. replacement booking | 8. booking record | 9. confirmation message | 10. duplicate booking

Calculate a different scheduling conflict

F Say it

A 1:00 appointment is delayed to 1:15. Its usual duration is forty-five minutes. The client must leave at 1:50 and accepts a 9:30 replacement tomorrow. The salon waives the change fee for its own delay.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

2:00 / waived / 9:30 / ten

Reception: "The ordinary finish would be ¹ _____."

Client: "That is ² _____ minutes after my departure deadline."

Reception: "Tomorrow's replacement is at ³ _____."

Reception: "The change fee is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. 2:00 | 2. ten | 3. 9:30 | 4. waived

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the timing exchange. Say 2:20, forty minutes, 3:00, and 2:45 distinctly.
2. Switch roles and read the replacement booking. Stress the waived change fee without implying that the haircut is free.
3. Complete the transfer, check the calculation in the key, and read the replacement time as a replacement, not an additional booking.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Pause before the wash

A Read the situation

Acknowledge discomfort, clarify the client description, and arrange a check without diagnosing or prescribing a position.

05

Sam reported neck pressure before water started. Imani immediately stopped preparation and attended to the concern through the salon process. The dialogue takes place afterward: Sam is away from the basin and reports feeling comfortable. Noor, the lead stylist, has been asked to review the concern. Sam agrees to review only, not further preparation or washing. No cause or injury has been established. This is not a positioning or treatment demonstration; immediate assistance must not wait for a twenty-turn conversation, and medical or emergency help follows actual response procedures when needed.

PEOPLE / Sam: Client | Imani: Salon assistant

A PAUSE IS A SERVICE RESPONSE

Some clients minimize discomfort because they do not want to interrupt the appointment. Respond plainly and respectfully when they speak up. Agreement to a comfort check is not the same as agreement to restart; ask about the specific next step.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has not started?

- | | |
|--|--------------------------------|
| A The request for a comfort check | B The water and wash |
| C The client's description | D The preparation pause |

2. Where does Sam describe pressure?

- | | |
|--|----------------------------|
| A Across the forehead | B Only at the wrist |
| C At the back of the neck against the support | D Inside the ear |

3. What does Sam agree to?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Immediate restart without a check | B A medical diagnosis |
| C A prescribed new body position | D A comfort check, not starting the wash |

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

wash station

Area equipped for washing a client's hair.

IN USE identify the wash station

basin

Bowl at the wash station.

IN USE refer to the basin

neck support

Surface or fitting supporting the neck at the basin.

IN USE check the neck support

contact point

Place where the body touches a support or surface.

IN USE identify the contact point

pressure

Sensation of force against an area, described by the client.

IN USE describe the pressure

discomfort

Unpleasant sensation that the client reports.

IN USE acknowledge discomfort

comfort check

Review of the client's comfort before proceeding.

IN USE arrange a comfort check

preparation

Work done before the wash itself starts.

IN USE pause preparation

pause

Temporary stop pending clarification or a check.

IN USE keep preparation paused

resume

Begin again after a pause with the required agreement.

IN USE confirm before resuming

consent to continue

Agreement to proceed with a specific next action.

IN USE ask for consent to continue

client report

The client's own account of a sensation or concern.

IN USE preserve the client report

Precision check

Sam reports pressure where the neck meets the support. That description is not a diagnosis. The water has not started, preparation is paused, and Noor is asked to review the concern before any decision to continue.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

location

Specific area where the sensation is felt.

IN USE clarify the location

onset

When a sensation began, without diagnosing its cause.

IN USE ask about onset

intensity

How strong a sensation feels to the client.

IN USE clarify reported intensity

persistent

Continuing rather than stopping immediately.

IN USE describe persistent discomfort

intermittent

Occurring at intervals rather than continuously.

IN USE describe intermittent pressure

sensitivity

Reported discomfort or response to contact, without a diagnosis.

IN USE record reported sensitivity

scalp

Skin covering the head beneath the hair.

IN USE distinguish scalp from neck

support adjustment

Change to a support, subject to appropriate assessment.

IN USE request a support adjustment review

positioning

How the client is placed, not a prescription made by this exercise.

IN USE refer a positioning concern

lead stylist

Senior salon colleague handling the relevant service concern.

IN USE contact the lead stylist

reassurance

Supportive communication that should not become an unsupported safety guarantee.

IN USE offer measured reassurance

agreed next step

Specific action the client and staff have confirmed.

IN USE state the agreed next step

Precision check

Keep permission specific: yes to a comfort check does not mean yes to the wash. Do not prescribe a new position, dismiss the sensation as normal, or promise that changing the support will resolve an unknown cause.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE PROMPTLY

"Thank you for telling me; we will pause here."

ASK FOR LOCATION

"Where are you feeling the pressure?"

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"I cannot determine the cause from that description."

ASK PERMISSION FOR REVIEW

"Would you like me to ask Noor to review the comfort concern?"

CONFIRM THE SERVICE STATE

"The water has not started."

USE THE CLIENT'S DESCRIPTION

"You feel pressure where your neck meets the support."

KEEP THE PAUSE EXPLICIT

"Preparation remains paused while we check."

NAME THE NEXT PERSON

"Noor is the lead stylist handling this check."

Feels versus is

Feels uncomfortable reports experience; is injured asserts a condition not established here.

Pause versus cancel

A pause stops the current action without automatically ending every future service.

Before

Before water starts fixes the sequence and prevents an inaccurate incident account.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE CONSENT

"Agreeing to the check does not mean starting the wash."

PRESERVE THE REPORT

"I will pass on your description in your own terms."

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

"Is the pressure at that contact point what you want me to report?"

CONFIRM THE BOUNDARY

"We have not agreed to resume yet."

AVOID MINIMIZATION

"I will not assume the discomfort is something you should tolerate."

DO NOT DELAY ASSISTANCE

"We will attend to your discomfort immediately; the longer discussion can wait."

AVOID A GUARANTEE

"We have not established what will resolve it."

CLOSE THE IMMEDIATE EXCHANGE

"The next step is the comfort check, with the preparation still paused."

Permission scope

Permission for review applies to review, not every later action.

Client wording

Specific reported pressure is more accurate than an invented medical label.

No minimization

Polite reassurance should not pressure a client to continue through discomfort.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which report is factual?

- A** Sam describes pressure at the back of the neck against the support.
- B** Sam has a diagnosed neck injury.
- C** The wash caused the condition.
- D** The support adjustment will certainly cure it.

2. Which action is agreed?

- A** Ask Noor for a comfort check while preparation stays paused.
- B** Restart water because Sam agreed to speak.
- C** Prescribe a particular neck angle.
- D** Treat the concern as resolved without review.

3. Which reassurance overreaches?

- A** I will report the pressure you described.
- B** This is definitely harmless, so we can carry on.
- C** Thank you for telling me.
- D** We will pause preparation.

4. Which chronology is accurate?

- A** Discomfort was reported before water started.
- B** Discomfort followed a completed wash.
- C** Water had been running for ten minutes.
- D** The appointment had ended before the report.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Pause before the wash

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

agreed next step / consent / preparation / lead stylist / resume / discomfort / contact point / water / client report / comfort check

- 01 **Sam:** The pressure was right at the back of my neck. Thank you for stopping; I feel comfortable now that we're away from the basin.
- 02 **Imani:** I'm glad you told me. The ¹ _____ is still paused. We won't begin washing while this is unresolved.
- 03 **Sam:** I thought I should mention it straight away, but I was worried about holding up the appointment.
- 04 **Imani:** Please tell us. You don't need to tolerate ² _____ to keep the appointment moving. Noor can review the concern with you.
- 05 **Sam:** Is Noor the person who checks the wash station? I don't know who I should explain it to.
- 06 **Imani:** Noor is our ³ _____. I've asked for the review. We follow our response procedures if further help is needed.
- 07 **Sam:** All right. It was where my neck touched the support, not across my scalp. Please make that clear.
- 08 **Imani:** I'll describe that ⁴ _____ exactly. Was that the wording you wanted me to pass on?
- 09 **Sam:** Yes. I can't tell whether it was the support or the position. I only know how it felt.
- 10 **Imani:** Your ⁵ _____ is enough to explain the concern. I won't guess the cause.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Sam:** Please don't write that the water was too hot. You hadn't turned it on.
- 12 **Imani:** Correct. The ⁶ _____ hadn't started. The report will say pressure during preparation, before the wash.
- 13 **Sam:** Can Noor look at it without us starting again? I'd like to hear what's proposed first.
- 14 **Imani:** Yes. The ⁷ _____ is separate from agreeing to continue. Asking for it doesn't commit you to another attempt.
- 15 **Sam:** Good. I feel better now, but I don't want that taken as an automatic yes.
- 16 **Imani:** Understood. Feeling comfortable now doesn't give ⁸ _____ for the next step. We'll ask you directly.
- 17 **Sam:** If we do continue, will you explain anything that needs to change before you do it?
- 18 **Imani:** Yes. Before we ⁹ _____ preparation, the proposal needs to be clear and agreed. I can't promise an unassessed adjustment will solve it.
- 19 **Sam:** Then please keep it paused. I'm agreeing to speak with Noor, not to have my hair washed yet.
- 20 **Imani:** That's the ¹⁰ _____: review with Noor, your report passed on, and no washing started.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. preparation | 2. discomfort | 3. lead stylist | 4. contact point | 5. client report | 6. water | 7. comfort check | 8. consent | 9. resume | 10. agreed next step

Report discomfort without adding a diagnosis

F Say it

Before water starts, a client reports pressure behind the neck against the support. Preparation is paused. The client agrees to a comfort review with lead stylist Jo but has not agreed to resume.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pressure / started / resume / review

Assistant: "The reported sensation is ¹ _____."

Client: "The water has not ² _____."

Assistant: "The agreed next step is a comfort ³ _____."

Client: "I have not agreed to ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. pressure | 2. started | 3. review | 4. resume

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the exchange as a follow-up after immediate assistance, not while leaving a client uncomfortable.
2. Switch roles. Stress before water started and review only when correcting the possible misunderstanding.
3. Complete and check the comfort transfer. Read the limited agreement without treating it as permission to wash.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

What does forty-five include?

A Read the situation

Explain an optional service, compare complete totals, and confirm a client choice before adding anything.

Client Aisha believes the advertised \$45 haircut includes a finish. Stylist Ben explains that this fictional menu lists the haircut at \$45 and an optional finish at \$15, with no other charges in the exercise. Neither service has begun. The complete choices are \$45 for the haircut only or \$60 for both services. Aisha asks whether buying a styling product is required; Ben confirms it is not part of either quoted service choice. Aisha chooses the haircut only, with no finish or retail product added.

PEOPLE / Aisha: Client | Ben: Stylist

06

MAKE THE OPTIONAL PART GENUINELY OPTIONAL

Clients may assume a familiar service name includes the same elements everywhere. Explain the specific menu without implying they should have known. State the full comparison before seeking a choice, and do not let a product recommendation become an unrequested purchase.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the haircut-only total?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| A \$45 | B \$15 |
| C \$60 | D \$75 |

2. What is the complete combined total?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| A \$90 | B \$60 |
| C \$45 | D \$15 |

3. What does Aisha choose?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Haircut and finish | B A retail product instead of a haircut |
| C Both services without a price discussion | D Haircut only, with no finish or product added |

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service menu

List describing available services and their prices.

IN USE explain the service menu

base service

Main service before optional additions.

IN USE identify the base service

optional finish

Separately offered final styling service in this menu.

IN USE explain the optional finish

add-on

Additional item or service requiring agreement.

IN USE confirm an add-on

inclusive price

Price covering the specified listed elements.

IN USE clarify the inclusive price

combined total

Sum payable for the selected services together.

IN USE state the combined total

itemized price

Price shown separately for each component.

IN USE provide an itemized price

service inclusion

Element covered by a particular service description.

IN USE clarify service inclusions

service exclusion

Element not covered by the quoted service.

IN USE explain service exclusions

retail product

Product sold for the client to take away.

IN USE discuss a retail product

product recommendation

Suggested product, not an automatic purchase.

IN USE separate a recommendation from a sale

styling cream

Product category used to help shape or manage a style.

IN USE describe a styling cream

06

Precision check

The styling finish is optional and costs \$15 in addition to the \$45 haircut. Both services total \$60; the haircut-only choice remains \$45. There are no other charges in this fictional comparison, and no retail product is included.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

mousse

Foam-format styling product.

IN USE identify a mousse

gel

Gel-format product used for styling or hold.

IN USE describe a gel

pomade

Styling-product category often associated with shape, control, or sheen.

IN USE clarify a pomade preference

finishing spray

Spray product used as a finishing step, subject to client preference.

IN USE discuss finishing spray

hold

Degree of styling control claimed for a product.

IN USE compare hold descriptions

shine

Degree of visible sheen in a finish.

IN USE describe the shine

matte finish

Low-shine appearance in a product or style description.

IN USE clarify a matte finish

product claim

Statement made about a product's characteristics or effects.

IN USE check a product claim

purchase decision

Client's choice whether to buy an item.

IN USE confirm the purchase decision

service authorization

Permission to carry out the specified service.

IN USE confirm service authorization

price misunderstanding

Difference between what the client expected and what the menu includes.

IN USE resolve a price misunderstanding

charge confirmation

Read-back of the agreed amount and what it covers.

IN USE give a charge confirmation

06

Precision check

A recommendation is not a purchase decision. Product words such as hold, matte, and shine describe features to discuss; they do not establish suitability for every person or permission to add a product to the bill.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EXPECTATION

"I understand you thought the finish was included."

IDENTIFY THE OPTIONAL ELEMENT

"The finish is an optional \$15 addition."

PRESERVE THE BASE CHOICE

"The haircut-only option remains \$45."

ASK BEFORE ADDING

"Would you like the finish added, or the haircut only?"

REFER TO THE SPECIFIC MENU

"On this menu, the haircut is \$45."

STATE THE COMBINED TOTAL

"Both services together would be \$60."

CLARIFY THE COMPARISON

"Those are the complete totals for these two choices."

SEPARATE RECOMMENDATION AND SALE

"A product recommendation does not add it to your purchase."

Includes versus costs extra

Includes places an element inside the price; costs extra marks a separate charge.

Optional

The client can decline without losing the stated base-service choice.

Together versus each

Together gives the combined total; each would imply separate equal amounts.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CONFIRM NO PURCHASE REQUIREMENT

"Neither service choice requires a retail-product purchase here."

AVOID UNIVERSAL CLAIMS

"We need to check the actual product information and your preference."

RECORD THE EXCLUSIONS

"No finish or retail product will be added."

READ BACK THE CHARGE

"The agreed service is the haircut at \$45."

EXPLAIN A PRODUCT WORD

"Matte describes a lower-shine appearance."

CONFIRM THE DECISION

"You have chosen the haircut only."

RESOLVE WITHOUT BLAME

"Let us make the inclusions clear before we begin."

KEEP LATER CHANGES EXPLICIT

"We would confirm any later addition before proceeding."

06

Would be

This expresses the price of an option before it is chosen.

Recommendation versus authorization

Suggesting a product does not authorize sale or application.

No other charges

This is a supplied fictional fact, not a rule for every real salon price.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is complete?

- A** Finish \$15, with no base price mentioned.
- B** Both services \$45 because the client assumed so.
- C** Haircut only \$60 and finish extra.
- D** Haircut only \$45; haircut plus finish \$60.

2. Which question preserves a real choice?

- A** Shall I add the product because I mentioned it?
- B** Can we discuss the price after finishing?
- C** Would you like the \$60 combined option or the \$45 haircut only?
- D** You want the finish, do you not?

3. What does matte describe here?

- A** A stronger degree of hold
- B** A wetter, higher-shine look
- C** A thicker individual hair strand
- D** A lower-shine appearance

4. Which final read-back matches Aisha's decision?

- A** Haircut at \$45, with no finish or retail product added.
- B** Both services at \$60, plus an unpriced product.
- C** Finish only at \$15.
- D** Haircut and finish at \$45.

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

What does forty-five include?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

product recommendation / retail product / charge confirmation / matte finish / service menu / purchase decision / service authorization / combined total / base service / optional finish

06

- 01 **Aisha:** I thought the forty-five-dollar haircut included the finish. Before we start, can you explain what that price actually covers?
- 02 **Ben:** Of course. On this ¹ _____, the haircut is forty-five dollars, and the finish is listed separately as an optional fifteen-dollar addition.
- 03 **Aisha:** So if I have both, the final amount is not forty-five. I would like the complete number rather than just the extra amount.
- 04 **Ben:** The ² _____ for both services is sixty dollars. The haircut-only option is forty-five dollars, and those are the complete totals for these two choices.
- 05 **Aisha:** I hadn't realized it was separate. Can I have the haircut without paying for the extra styling?
- 06 **Ben:** The ³ _____ is your choice. Neither service has begun, and I will confirm what you want before adding anything to the agreed plan.
- 07 **Aisha:** Can I just have the haircut today? I am keeping to a budget, and I would rather understand the basic option clearly.
- 08 **Ben:** Yes. The ⁴ _____ here is the haircut at forty-five dollars. Declining the finish does not remove that option or turn it into the sixty-dollar combined service.
- 09 **Aisha:** I also heard someone mention a styling product. Do I have to buy one to have the haircut-only option at that price?
- 10 **Ben:** No. A ⁵ _____ is not part of either quoted service choice, and neither requires a product purchase here. Discussing one does not mean adding it to your bill.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Aisha:** Good. I thought buying something might be part of the deal. I'm not looking for a product today.
- 12 **Ben:** We can keep the ⁶ _____ separate from the service decision. You can ask about a feature without agreeing to buy anything.
- 13 **Aisha:** For example, what does matte mean? I have seen it on products, but I am not sure whether it describes strength or something else.
- 14 **Ben:** A ⁷ _____ describes a lower-shine appearance. Hold is a different feature, and the actual product information matters when comparing what a particular item claims.
- 15 **Aisha:** Ah, so matte doesn't tell me how strong the hold is. I was mixing those up.
- 16 **Ben:** Exactly. The ⁸ _____ is separate from the discussion. I will not add a product simply because we have talked about its description.
- 17 **Aisha:** Then please keep today to the haircut only, at forty-five dollars. No optional finish and no retail product for me.
- 18 **Ben:** I will record that ⁹ _____: haircut only at forty-five dollars, with no finish or retail product added. We have clarified the choice before either service begins.
- 19 **Aisha:** That's right. I'd rather know the price now than question it at the till.
- 20 **Ben:** Let me give the final ¹⁰ _____: forty-five dollars for the haircut. Any later addition would need its own clear discussion and agreement; nothing extra has been selected today.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. service menu | 2. combined total | 3. optional finish | 4. base service | 5. retail product | 6. product recommendation | 7. matte finish | 8. purchase decision | 9. service authorization | 10. charge confirmation

Compare another optional service

F Say it

A fictional menu lists a haircut at \$50 and an optional finish at \$20, with no other charges. The client chooses the haircut only and declines a retail product. Nothing has begun.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

optional / selected / seventy / fifty

Stylist: "Both services would total ¹ _____ dollars."

Client: "My haircut-only choice is ² _____ dollars."

Stylist: "The finish is ³ _____."

Client: "No retail product is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. seventy | 2. fifty | 3. optional | 4. selected

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read both complete prices: \$45 for the haircut and \$60 with the optional styling finish.
2. Switch roles and read the product exchange. Contrast matte appearance with hold; retain the no-purchase decision.
3. Complete and check the price transfer. Read the selected service and excluded extras before the final total.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The left side looks longer

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a specific result concern, separate appearance from confirmed findings, and arrange review before promising a remedy.

At checkout, client Mei says the left side of the haircut looks longer. Receptionist Rafael hears that the earlier consultation promised an even outline. The current appearance has not been reviewed together with stylist Jo. Rafael pauses checkout and offers a mirror review with Jo. Mei accepts the review. No cause has been established, and neither a correction nor a refund has been approved. The conversation must not turn a reported concern into a confirmed cutting error, a promise to remove more hair, or an automatic payment resolution.

PEOPLE / Mei: Client | Rafael: Receptionist

07

ACKNOWLEDGE WITHOUT DECIDING THE FINDING

You can take a concern seriously without declaring either that the client is mistaken or that the stylist made an error. Repeat the observable concern, arrange a specific review, and keep the client informed about what has and has not been agreed.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Mei report?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|--|
| A The left side looks longer | B The right side has already been corrected |
| C A refund has been approved | D The stylist has confirmed the cause |

2. What was the earlier agreed expectation?

- | | |
|--|-----------------------------------|
| A No discussion of the outline | B An even outline |
| C A deliberately uneven outline | D A shorter left side only |

3. What is accepted now?

- | | |
|---|----------------------------------|
| A A confirmed fault diagnosis | B A mirror review with Jo |
| C Immediate removal of more hair | D An approved refund |

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

result concern

Client's question or dissatisfaction about the service outcome.

IN USE acknowledge a result concern

even outline

Outer edge intended to look balanced in length.

IN USE review the even outline

apparent difference

Difference that seems visible before assessment confirms details.

IN USE describe the apparent difference

left side

Client's left-hand side, clarified from the client's perspective.

IN USE identify the left side

right side

Client's right-hand side, distinguished from a mirror image.

IN USE compare the right side

mirror review

Joint examination of the appearance using a mirror.

IN USE arrange a mirror review

hand mirror

Portable mirror used to show another view.

IN USE offer a hand mirror

viewing angle

Direction from which the result is being seen.

IN USE clarify the viewing angle

client perspective

The client's view or orientation, important for side references.

IN USE confirm the client perspective

reported expectation

What the client says was agreed earlier.

IN USE record the reported expectation

consultation note

Record of preferences and agreed service details.

IN USE check the consultation note

assessment finding

Conclusion reached through the relevant review.

IN USE distinguish an assessment finding

Precision check

Mei reports that the left side looks longer; no joint review has confirmed a cause or cutting error. The earlier expectation was an even outline. Acknowledging both facts does not authorize removing more hair.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cause

Reason for the apparent difference, not yet established.

IN USE avoid inventing a cause

correction

Additional work intended to address a confirmed concern.

IN USE discuss a proposed correction

remedy

Proposed response to a service concern.

IN USE clarify the proposed remedy

rework consent

Permission for specifically described additional service work.

IN USE confirm rework consent

refund request

Client's request for money to be returned.

IN USE record a refund request

refund approval

Authorized decision to return money under the relevant process.

IN USE distinguish refund approval

checkout pause

Temporary stop in the payment process while a concern is addressed.

IN USE confirm the checkout pause

service record

Record of what was discussed and performed.

IN USE review the service record

acknowledgment

Clear recognition that the concern has been heard.

IN USE give a specific acknowledgment

defensive response

Reply focused on resisting criticism rather than addressing the concern.

IN USE avoid a defensive response

premature conclusion

Finding stated before the evidence or review supports it.

IN USE avoid a premature conclusion

resolution status

Current stage of handling the concern.

IN USE state the resolution status

Precision check

Keep the next step distinct from the outcome. A mirror review is accepted, checkout is paused, and no correction or refund is approved. Further work requires a specific explanation and the relevant agreement, not an assumption that review implies consent.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE SPECIFICALLY

"I hear that the left side looks longer to you."

PAUSE THE TRANSACTION

"Let us pause checkout while we address the concern."

AVOID A FINDING TOO SOON

"We have not reviewed the appearance together yet."

CLARIFY ORIENTATION

"Do you mean your left side as you are sitting here?"

RECOGNIZE THE EXPECTATION

"You were expecting an even outline."

AVOID DISMISSAL

"I will not assume it is just your imagination."

OFFER A CONCRETE NEXT STEP

"Would you like a mirror review with Jo?"

PRESERVE THE WORDING

"I will pass on that it looks longer, not that a cause is confirmed."

07

Looks versus is

Looks longer reports perception; is longer asserts a confirmed comparison.

Your left

Clarifies orientation when a mirror or another person's viewpoint could confuse sides.

Review versus redo

Review examines the issue; redo implies additional service work.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE REVIEW AND CORRECTION

"Agreeing to review does not authorize more cutting."

KEEP PAYMENT STATUS ACCURATE

"No refund has been approved."

CHECK THE RECORD

"We can refer to the consultation note during the review."

KEEP THE CLIENT INVOLVED

"Any proposed further work should be explained before agreement."

AVOID A REMEDY PROMISE

"No correction has been approved yet."

INVITE THE RELEVANT EXPLANATION

"Jo can review the concern against the agreed outline."

CONFIRM THE ACCEPTED STEP

"You would like the mirror review first."

CLOSE WITHOUT PREMATURE RESOLUTION

"The review is the next step; the concern is not yet resolved."

Acknowledge versus admit

Acknowledging a concern does not automatically establish a fault finding.

Request versus approval

A requested refund and an authorized refund have different statuses.

First

First sequences review before any proposed remedy rather than guaranteeing a later outcome.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening is most useful?

- A** I will remove more hair immediately.
- B** I hear that the left side looks longer and that you expected an even outline.
- C** It cannot be uneven because our stylist is experienced.
- D** The stylist definitely cut it incorrectly.

2. Which statement confuses review with consent?

- A** Checkout is paused.
- B** Jo will review the concern.
- C** No refund is approved yet.
- D** Agreeing to the mirror review means we can cut more without asking.

3. Which handover is accurate?

- A** Client approved a refund.
- B** Client withdrew the concern.
- C** Client reports a longer-looking left side; joint review pending.
- D** Cutting error confirmed and fixed.

4. Which next step has been accepted?

- A** Immediate correction of both sides
- B** Closing the complaint as resolved
- C** Mirror review with Jo before deciding a remedy
- D** Automatic refund before review

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The left side looks longer

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reported concern / cause / permission to cut / correction / refund request / pending / pause
checkout / consultation note / even outline / mirror review

07

- 01 **Mei:** Before I pay, could someone look at this side? It seems longer than the other one, and we agreed on an even outline.
- 02 **Rafael:** Of course. Let's ¹ _____ while we look into it. Is it your left side you're pointing to?
- 03 **Mei:** Yes, my left. It's easier to see when I look straight ahead. I don't know whether it's the angle.
- 04 **Rafael:** I'll ask Jo to join you for a ² _____. You can point out the section rather than relying on my description.
- 05 **Mei:** Please. I'm not asking for a different style; I want to check the outline we discussed.
- 06 **Rafael:** I'll make that clear. You expected an ³ _____, and the left side currently looks longer to you.
- 07 **Mei:** Exactly. I was going to leave it, but I'd rather say something before I go home.
- 08 **Rafael:** Thank you for raising it. We can check the ⁴ _____ with Jo and make sure we're discussing the same plan.
- 09 **Mei:** Do you think it needs more taken off? I don't want it getting shorter and shorter.
- 10 **Rafael:** We haven't established the ⁵ _____ yet. Let's hear Jo's assessment before discussing whether further cutting is appropriate.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Mei:** Yes, and please explain any proposed change first. I'd like to see exactly where it would be.
- 12 **Rafael:** Absolutely. Looking together isn't ⁶ _____. You can ask questions before agreeing to any proposed work.
- 13 **Mei:** And if I'm still unhappy after we've looked at it, who can discuss the payment with me?
- 14 **Rafael:** We can take a ⁷ _____ through our salon process. I haven't approved a refund by pausing checkout.
- 15 **Mei:** Okay. I wasn't sure what happened next. For now, I'd like Jo to see this side.
- 16 **Rafael:** I'll pass on the ⁸ _____: your left looks longer, and you expected an even outline.
- 17 **Mei:** That's it. Please don't tell Jo I've asked for both sides to be cut shorter.
- 18 **Rafael:** I won't. A ⁹ _____ hasn't been agreed. The first step is to review the appearance together.
- 19 **Mei:** Thank you. I'll show Jo what I mean in the mirror before we decide anything else.
- 20 **Rafael:** Yes. The review is still ¹⁰ _____, and checkout stays paused while we arrange it.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. pause checkout | 2. mirror review | 3. even outline | 4. consultation note | 5. cause | 6. permission to cut | 7. refund request | 8. reported concern | 9. correction | 10. pending

Keep a second result concern factual

F Say it

A client says the right side looks fuller than expected. An even outline was agreed. A mirror review with stylist Kai is accepted. Checkout is paused; neither further cutting nor a refund is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

even / review / right / approved

Reception: "The reported concern is the ¹ _____ side."

Client: "We agreed on an ² _____ outline."

Reception: "The accepted next step is a mirror ³ _____."

Reception: "No refund is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. right | 2. even | 3. review | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the result concern. Use your left to keep the client's orientation clear.
2. Switch roles and read the review proposal, preserving the distinction between looking together and agreeing to more cutting.
3. Complete and check the transfer; read the right-side concern without switching back to the original left side.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Requested is not booked

A Read the situation

Hand over confirmed preferences, an unbooked consultation request, and photography permission as separate facts.

Stylist Sora is handing client details to receptionist Jordan. The client requested a future color consultation but has not booked it or accepted a date. Confirmed preferences from today are retained front length and no finishing spray. No agreement to promotional photographs is recorded. Sora and Jordan must preserve those distinctions when updating the record: a preference is not a booking, a request is not an accepted appointment, and participation in a salon service does not establish permission to use an image for promotion.

PEOPLE / Sora: Stylist | Jordan: Receptionist

08

PASS ON STATUSES, NOT CONVENIENT ASSUMPTIONS

A quick handover can accidentally turn interest into a booking or silence into agreement. Label each item according to what the client actually said. Read back the pending request and confirmed preferences separately so the next colleague does not have to reconstruct the conversation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What future service is requested?

- A A promotional photograph session
- C A completed color treatment

- B A color consultation, not yet booked
- D A confirmed appointment date

2. Which preferences are confirmed?

- A Any future color formula
- C Retained front length and no finishing spray

- B Unlimited promotional photography
- D Shorter front length and extra spray

3. What is the photography status?

- A Permission covers every future use
- C No promotional-photo agreement is recorded

- B The client approved a campaign
- D Consent is implied by visiting

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

client profile

Record of relevant client information and preferences.

IN USE update the client profile

preference note

Recorded choice about how the client wants a service handled.

IN USE preserve a preference note

front-length retention

Keeping the specified hair length toward the face.

IN USE confirm front-length retention

no-spray preference

Request not to use finishing spray.

IN USE record the no-spray preference

consultation request

Expression of interest in a consultation, not a confirmed appointment.

IN USE record the consultation request

pending booking

Appointment arrangement that is not yet confirmed.

IN USE distinguish a pending booking

accepted date

Appointment date the client has explicitly agreed to.

IN USE confirm the accepted date

follow-up contact

Later communication about an unresolved request.

IN USE arrange follow-up contact

handover

Transfer of relevant information and responsibility between colleagues.

IN USE give an accurate handover

read-back

Repetition of key details to confirm understanding.

IN USE perform a read-back

record amendment

Correction or update to an existing entry.

IN USE make a record amendment

service consent

Permission for a particular salon service.

IN USE distinguish service consent

08

Precision check

The color consultation is requested but unbooked. Retained front length and no finishing spray are confirmed preferences. No promotional-photo agreement is recorded. These three statuses should not be compressed into a vague statement that the client agreed to everything.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

image permission

Agreement concerning taking or using a person's image.

IN USE check image permission

promotional use

Use of material to advertise or market the salon.

IN USE clarify promotional use

portfolio image

Image displayed to demonstrate work, subject to appropriate permission.

IN USE discuss a portfolio image

publication channel

Place where content may be shared, such as a website.

IN USE specify a publication channel

permission scope

Exact action or use covered by an agreement.

IN USE confirm permission scope

recorded agreement

Agreement documented in the relevant record.

IN USE check the recorded agreement

unconfirmed assumption

Belief not supported by what the client has agreed.

IN USE remove an unconfirmed assumption

factual handover

Handover limited to accurate, relevant information.

IN USE provide a factual handover

open request

Request still awaiting a decision or arrangement.

IN USE track the open request

next contact owner

Person responsible for the next communication.

IN USE identify the next contact owner

status label

Word identifying whether an item is requested, pending, or confirmed.

IN USE use a precise status label

current record

Latest accurate version of the client information.

IN USE verify the current record

08

Precision check

Permission is purpose-specific. Do not infer promotional-image use from a completed service, a positive comment, or an unrecorded assumption. Use the actual salon process and applicable requirements for any later request involving taking or publishing images.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE HANDOVER

"I have two confirmed preferences and one unbooked request."

STATE THE SECOND PREFERENCE

"The client does not want finishing spray."

KEEP THE STATUS CLEAR

"The consultation is requested but not booked."

DISTINGUISH SERVICE AND IMAGE PERMISSION

"Service consent does not establish promotional-photo permission."

STATE THE FIRST PREFERENCE

"Please retain the front length."

NAME THE REQUESTED SERVICE

"The client requested a future color consultation."

AVOID INVENTING A DATE

"No appointment date has been accepted."

STATE THE RECORD ACCURATELY

"No promotional-photo agreement is recorded."

08

Requested versus booked

Interest or a request does not establish an accepted appointment.

Retain versus remove

Retain means keep the specified length rather than shorten it.

No spray

This is a product-use preference, not permission for every other product.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PREVENT AN ASSUMPTION

"Please do not mark that request as confirmed."

CORRECT A STATUS

"That should say requested, not booked."

KEEP FOLLOW-UP LIMITED

"Follow-up will address availability, not assume acceptance."

CONFIRM THE RECORD

"The profile should preserve these exact distinctions."

ASK FOR A READ-BACK

"Can you repeat the confirmed preferences and pending request?"

ASSIGN THE NEXT CONTACT

"Who will handle the next booking discussion?"

KEEP THE DETAILS SEPARATE

"The no-spray preference is not a color-service decision."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"Two preferences confirmed; consultation unbooked; photo agreement absent."

08

Recorded versus assumed

A documented agreement differs from a colleague's inference.

Purpose-specific permission

Agreement to a service does not automatically cover promotional use of an image.

Read-back

Repeating the status words catches errors that a general acknowledgment may miss.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover is accurate?

- A** Consultation completed and date accepted.
- B** Spray approved unless the client objects again.
- C** Retain front length; no spray; color consultation requested but unbooked.
- D** Color treatment booked and product choices unrestricted.

2. What does no promotional-photo agreement recorded mean?

- A** A colleague can assume unlimited publication.
- B** The client approved every channel.
- C** Do not treat promotional use as authorized.
- D** Permission is automatic after a paid service.

3. Which label should replace an inaccurate booked entry?

- A** Paid in full
- B** Automatically renewed
- C** Requested, not booked
- D** Completed

4. Which read-back catches a meaningful error?

- A** Color consultation means we can book color application.
- B** No spray means any cream or gel has been approved.
- C** No date accepted; the consultation remains unbooked.
- D** Date offered, so I have marked the consultation confirmed.

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

Requested is not booked

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

no-spray preference / read-back / consultation request / client profile / recorded / Service consent / unbooked / follow-up contact / booking status / retain

08

- 01 **Sora:** Could we check the client notes before you take over? There are two preferences and a color enquiry to pass on.
- 02 **Jordan:** Yes. I'll open the ¹ _____. What should I put first?
- 03 **Sora:** Keep the front length, and no finishing spray. Please don't shorten that to just natural-looking.
- 04 **Jordan:** I'll write ² _____ front length. Does no spray refer specifically to finishing spray?
- 05 **Sora:** It does. Those are the client's words. We didn't agree to a different product instead.
- 06 **Jordan:** Then the ³ _____ gets its own line. That should be easier for the next stylist to spot.
- 07 **Sora:** The client also asked about a future color consultation. We haven't picked a date or booked anything.
- 08 **Jordan:** So a ⁴ _____, not a color treatment booking. Did you offer a particular time?
- 09 **Sora:** No. Reception needs to discuss availability with the client. I don't want a reminder going out before that happens.
- 10 **Jordan:** I'll leave it ⁵ _____. I'll handle the availability discussion, then confirm any choice with the client.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Sora:** One more thing: there's no agreement to promotional photos in the record. Please don't mark that as permission.
- 12 **Jordan:** Understood. ⁶ _____ doesn't cover a promotional image. We need the appropriate separate conversation for that.
- 13 **Sora:** Right. If someone asks about a portfolio picture later, the note mustn't suggest we've already dealt with it.
- 14 **Jordan:** I'll state that no photo agreement is ⁷ _____, rather than guessing which uses the client would accept.
- 15 **Sora:** Can you read the summary back? The booked-versus-requested bit is the one I'm most concerned about.
- 16 **Jordan:** Here's the ⁸ _____: retain front length, no finishing spray, future color consultation requested but unbooked; no promotional-photo agreement recorded.
- 17 **Sora:** Yes, that's right. The client hasn't agreed to a date, a color formula, or an alternative finishing product.
- 18 **Jordan:** I'll keep the ⁹ _____ separate from the preference notes. The consultation remains a follow-up request.
- 19 **Sora:** Thank you. Please make sure whoever sees the next appointment has those preferences in front of them.
- 20 **Jordan:** I'll update the record and take the ¹⁰ _____. Any offered slot still needs the client's acceptance.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. client profile | 2. retain | 3. no-spray preference | 4. consultation request | 5. unbooked | 6. Service consent | 7. recorded | 8. read-back | 9. booking status | 10. follow-up contact

Read back a new client handover

F Say it

The client confirms retained side length and no finishing spray. A future styling consultation is requested but unbooked. Reception will handle the next availability discussion. No promotional-image agreement is recorded.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reception / unbooked / side / recorded

08

Stylist: "Please retain the ¹ _____ length."

Reception: "The consultation is requested but ² _____."

Stylist: "The next availability discussion belongs to ³ _____."

Reception: "No promotional-image agreement is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. side | 2. unbooked | 3. reception | 4. recorded

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the handover. Emphasize retain front length and no finishing spray as separate preferences.
2. Switch roles and repeat the read-back exactly, preserving requested but unbooked and no photo agreement recorded.
3. Complete and check the transfer. Keep retained side length distinct from the front-length preference in the longer exchange.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Length in the way you wear it

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Distinguish visible curl length, strand thickness, and density when agreeing on a shape.

Client Nia wears her hair in its natural curls. Stretched, it reaches below her shoulders; dry and unstretched, it sits at shoulder level. She wants to keep that dry shoulder-length outline and more crown volume. The consultation records fine individual strands and high density. No amount to remove or cutting method is agreed.

PEOPLE / Nia: Client | Amir: Stylist

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Strand thickness / natural fall / dry outline / shrinkage / density / crown volume

- 01 **Nia:** When I say shoulder-length, I mean how it sits when I leave it curly. Last time, the wet length looked right but the dry result felt too short.
- 02 **Amir:** Then let's use your ¹ _____ as the reference. You want the bottom to stay at shoulder level when worn naturally.
- 03 **Nia:** Exactly. If I pull a section straight, it goes below my shoulders. That's not how I wear it during the day.
- 04 **Amir:** That difference is ² _____. We need to account for how your curls sit, without assuming every section springs back equally.
- 05 **Nia:** I'd like more height at the top, though. Does that mean losing the length around the bottom?
- 06 **Amir:** Your requested ³ _____ is a separate goal. Let's discuss possible shape changes before deciding how much, if anything, comes off each area.
- 07 **Nia:** People call my hair thick, but the individual hairs feel quite fine. Is that a contradiction?
- 08 **Amir:** No. ⁴ _____ describes each hair. Density describes how much hair grows in an area. Your consultation records fine strands with high density.
- 09 **Nia:** That explains it. I have a lot of hair, but I don't want a heavy product recommendation based just on the word thick.
- 10 **Amir:** Agreed. We'll keep ⁵ _____ separate from strand thickness and your styling preferences. Neither description alone chooses a product for you.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Nia:** The curls at the front sit differently from the back. Please don't assume the whole head behaves like one section.
- 12 **Amir:** I won't. We can compare the areas in their ⁶ _____ and discuss the shape you actually wear.
- 13 **Nia:** Would it help if I showed you where I want the bottom edge in the mirror?
- 14 **Amir:** Yes. That gives us a shared visual reference. It still doesn't turn shoulder-length into a fixed number of centimeters to remove everywhere.
- 15 **Nia:** Right. I'm asking to keep that edge, not to cut every wet section to the same shoulder line.
- 16 **Amir:** Understood. We haven't agreed on a cutting method or an amount yet. First we'll confirm the shape and the length you want protected.
- 17 **Nia:** And the crown goal is more volume, not straightening. I want to keep wearing the curls.
- 18 **Amir:** That's clear. I'll record natural curls, retained dry shoulder-length outline, and a discussion of crown volume. No straightening service has been requested.
- 19 **Nia:** Please read that back before we start, including the dry-length point. That's the part I don't want lost.
- 20 **Amir:** Certainly. Shoulder-level when dry and unstretched; more crown volume to discuss; fine strands, high density; cutting details still to be agreed.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. dry outline | 2. shrinkage | 3. crown volume | 4. Strand thickness | 5. density | 6. natural fall

Protect the unstretched endpoint

F Say it in a new situation

A client wants chin-level hair when dry and unstretched, not the collarbone endpoint seen when stretched. Individual hairs are coarse, but density is low. No cutting amount is agreed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

coarse / low / stretched / chin

09

Client: Keep the dry outline at my ¹ _____ .

Stylist: The longer comparison shows the hair ² _____ .

Client: The individual strands are ³ _____ .

Stylist: The recorded density is ⁴ _____ .

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. chin | 2. stretched | 3. coarse | 4. low

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

A number needs a length

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Read a tool-specific guard chart and distinguish length left from length removed.

For this consultation, the shop's identified hair-clipper chart lists nominal lengths: #1 = 3 mm, #2 = 6 mm, #3 = 10 mm, #4 = 13 mm. Client Pavel first says number two, thinking it means removing 2 mm. He clarifies a preference around 13 mm at the sides. Top, neckline, and beard remain unagreed; no cutting begins.

PEOPLE / Pavel: Client | Leah: Barber

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

left / guide comb / separate agreement / number four / millimeters / number two

10

- 01 **Pavel:** Could you do a number two on the sides? I only want a little off, not a really close cut.
- 02 **Leah:** Let's check what you mean. On this hair-clipper chart, ¹ _____ is listed as six millimeters remaining. Were you expecting that length?
- 03 **Pavel:** Oh, no. I thought two meant taking off two millimeters. I'd like the sides much longer than six.
- 04 **Leah:** The chart describes the length ² _____, not the amount removed. It's worth checking before we choose a guard.
- 05 **Pavel:** About thirteen millimeters sounds nearer what I meant. Which number is that on your chart?
- 06 **Leah:** That's ³ _____. We'll discuss the appearance at that length before treating the number as the whole haircut plan.
- 07 **Pavel:** And number three is ten millimeters? I can see the printed lengths now. They're not counting up one millimeter at a time.
- 08 **Leah:** Correct. Read the stated ⁴ _____, not just the sequence of numbers. These are the listed nominal lengths for this identified tool system.
- 09 **Pavel:** My beard trimmer has numbers too. Could I use the same number and expect exactly the same result?
- 10 **Leah:** Not automatically. Check that tool's ⁵ _____ and instructions. A remembered number from another device isn't enough to identify a matching length.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Pavel:** So if I come back, I should mention the length as well as the number. That would avoid this mix-up.
- 12 **Leah:** Yes, along with the areas and appearance you liked. Tool settings and the final look still need checking on the actual hair.
- 13 **Pavel:** Does asking for thirteen millimeters at the sides mean you'll cut the top to thirteen as well?
- 14 **Leah:** No. We need a ⁶ _____ about the top. The neckline and your beard haven't been discussed either.
- 15 **Pavel:** Please leave the beard out of today's haircut conversation for now. I haven't decided what I want done with it.
- 16 **Leah:** Understood. No beard work is agreed. We'll finish the haircut consultation without adding that service by assumption.
- 17 **Pavel:** And is thirteen a promise that every single hair will measure exactly thirteen afterward?
- 18 **Leah:** No. It's the chart's nominal length, not a guarantee about every hair. We still need to agree the shape and appropriate professional approach.
- 19 **Pavel:** Then my original number-two request was wrong. Please record the longer side preference and check the remaining details with me.
- 20 **Leah:** I will: around thirteen millimeters at the sides, number four on this chart as our reference, with the rest of the plan still to confirm.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. number two | 2. left | 3. number four | 4. millimeters | 5. guide comb | 6. separate agreement

Read another chart entry

F Say it in a new situation

Use the same chart: #1 = 3 mm, #2 = 6 mm, #3 = 10 mm, #4 = 13 mm. A client wants approximately 10 mm remaining at the sides. The beard has not been discussed. Interpret the request only; no technique is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unagreed / removed / ten / three

Client: I want approximately ¹ _____ millimeters remaining at the sides.

Barber: On this chart, that is guard number ² _____.

Client: The chart describes length left, not length ³ _____.

Barber: Work on the beard is still ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. ten | 2. three | 3. removed | 4. unagreed

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Read the color record precisely

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Separate starting areas, a strand-test observation, the desired tone, and outstanding safety checks.

Fictional record review, not service instructions: client Mara has natural regrowth recorded at level 5 and previously colored lengths at level 7, warm. An earlier professionally assessed strand sample is recorded as level 7, still warm. Her goal is level 7, cool. The applicable allergy-alert assessment is incomplete. No formula, whole-head service, price, or timing is approved.

PEOPLE / Mara: Client | Tariq: Colorist

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

strand test / allergy-alert assessment / tone / previously colored lengths / level / Regrowth

11

- 01 **Mara:** The note says level seven on the test strand. Isn't that the level I wanted? I'm wondering why the color plan isn't ready.
- 02 **Tariq:** It matches the requested ¹ _____, but the note also says still warm. Your goal is level seven with a cool tone.
- 03 **Mara:** So reaching seven doesn't mean the test looks like my goal. We need to read the words after the number too.
- 04 **Tariq:** Exactly. The recorded ² _____ is different. We shouldn't summarize that as a perfect match.
- 05 **Mara:** I can also see level five beside regrowth. Is that a second description of the same test strand?
- 06 **Tariq:** No. ³ _____ refers to the naturally grown area near your scalp. That starting area is recorded at level five.
- 07 **Mara:** And the level-seven warm entry beside lengths describes the hair that was colored before, not all my hair from root to tip.
- 08 **Tariq:** Right. The ⁴ _____ have a different starting record. Keeping the areas separate prevents a misleading whole-head summary.
- 09 **Mara:** Does the strand result tell you exactly what every part of my hair will do if you use the same approach?
- 10 **Tariq:** No. The ⁵ _____ gives information about that sample. It doesn't guarantee an identical response across different areas.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Mara:** I thought a test meant the safety checks were finished too. Is that a different part of the record?
- 12 **Tariq:** Yes. The applicable ⁶ _____ is incomplete. The hair sample's color result doesn't complete that requirement.
- 13 **Mara:** Then I shouldn't read test done as meaning everything is cleared for application. I can see why the labels matter.
- 14 **Tariq:** Exactly. We follow the actual product warnings, required checks, and salon procedures. This conversation doesn't provide a test method or permission to apply color.
- 15 **Mara:** Could you just increase the processing time to make the result cooler? I'm trying to understand what changes next.
- 16 **Tariq:** We can't invent that instruction from these notes. Any proposed service needs professional assessment and the product's actual directions; more time isn't an automatic solution.
- 17 **Mara:** All right. Before I book, I want to understand the proposed result, the cost, and how long the appointment would be.
- 18 **Tariq:** Those are still to be agreed. No formula, price, service duration, or whole-head application has been approved in this record.
- 19 **Mara:** Please keep the goal as level seven cool, and the sample as level seven warm. Don't overwrite one with the other.
- 20 **Tariq:** I won't. I'll retain the separate starting areas, the observed sample result, the requested goal, and the incomplete assessment so the next discussion starts from the facts.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. level | 2. tone | 3. Regrowth | 4. previously colored lengths | 5. strand test | 6. allergy-alert assessment

Do not convert a sample into clearance

F Say it in a new situation

A fictional record lists a desired level 6 neutral and a tested hair sample at level 6 warm. The applicable allergy-alert assessment remains incomplete. No whole-head color service is authorized.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

neutral / warm / incomplete / six

Client: The sample and goal share level ¹ _____ .

Colorist: The requested tone is ² _____ .

Client: The sample is still described as ³ _____ .

Colorist: The allergy-alert assessment is ⁴ _____ .

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. six | 2. neutral | 3. warm | 4. incomplete

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Turning a reference photo into a clear request

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What practical feature matters to Alex?

D. Enough retained length for a low ponytail

Alex wants to retain practical length rather than copy the photograph exactly.

2. Which endpoint is agreed for the outline discussion?

B. Collarbone length

The clarification establishes collarbone length instead of the reference's chin-length endpoint.

3. What is the fringe status?

B. No fringe is requested

Alex explicitly confirms that the fringe in the reference is not requested.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which read-back preserves the agreement?

B. Collarbone-length outline, retain ponytail length, no fringe

The read-back includes the chosen length, practical requirement, and explicit fringe exclusion.

2. Which feature needs separate consent?

D. The straight fringe shown in the photo

A visible feature is not automatically requested merely because it appears in the reference.

3. What does trim fail to specify on its own?

B. The agreed amount or endpoint of length removal

Trim is imprecise unless the amount or resulting length is clarified.

4. Which promise is unsupported?

B. Every strand will definitely fit into a ponytail based only on this photo.

The reference does not establish how all of Alex's actual hair sections will tie back.

01 Conversation answers

Turning a reference photo into a clear request

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. reference photo. Turn 2. The photograph starts a discussion; it does not authorize copying every visible feature.

2. chin-length. Turn 4. The reference ends at the chin, which Alex has not chosen as the new endpoint.

3. collarbone-length. Turn 6. Collarbone length is the longer direction Alex chooses for discussion, not a guaranteed ponytail result.

4. perimeter. Turn 8. Perimeter means the outer edge defining the haircut, rather than every internal length.

5. fringe. Turn 10. Fringe and bangs name the front feature that Alex explicitly declines in this conversation.

6. retained length. Turn 12. Retained length is what stays, not the amount removed during the haircut.

7. read back. Turn 14. Reading back repeats the selected details so Alex can correct them before cutting.

8. trim. Turn 16. A trim suggests limited removal but does not specify an agreed amount or final endpoint.

9. length removal. Turn 18. Length removal means the amount cut off, distinct from where the finished ends will sit.

10. agreed direction. Turn 20. The agreed direction records the chosen outline and exclusions without inventing an exact cutting plan.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. shoulder-length

Stylist: "The agreed outline is shoulder-length."

Shoulder length is the confirmed direction, not the reference's shorter endpoint.

2. front

Client: "Please retain the front length."

Front length is the specific feature the client wants preserved.

3. bangs

Stylist: "No bangs are requested."

Bangs are explicitly declined despite any appearance in the reference.

4. started

Client: "The cut has not yet started."

The brief places the clarification before any cutting begins.

02 Briefing and language checks

Describing shape, texture, and everyday styling

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What does Morgan want at the neckline?

C. Less fullness

Morgan asks for reduced neckline fullness while separately declining exposed sides.

2. Which supplied photo shows covered sides?

B. Photo A

Photo A is described as retaining visible hair over the sides.

3. How much daily styling time does Morgan report?

B. Five minutes

The brief states five minutes as Morgan's current morning styling allowance.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which comparison is supported?

D. A shows covered sides; B shows exposed skin at the shortest area.

Only the supplied visible difference is established by the two photographs.

2. Which clarification best follows less bulk?

D. Where does the fullness bother you most?

The location question clarifies the requested change without inventing removal or exposure.

3. What remains unagreed?

D. The cutting method and exact length

The brief explicitly leaves the method and exact length unagreed.

4. Which summary preserves both preferences?

A. Reduce neckline fullness while retaining visible side coverage.

The correct summary keeps the desired reduction and the coverage boundary distinct.

02 Conversation answers

Describing shape, texture, and everyday styling

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. neckline. Turn 2. Neckline identifies the lower boundary at the back where Morgan wants less fullness, separate from the side-coverage preference.

2. coverage. Turn 4. Coverage means hair remains visibly over the sides, which matches Morgan's stated preference in this comparison.

3. Exposed skin. Turn 6. Exposed skin is the feature Morgan declines; reducing fullness at the neckline does not authorize adding it at the sides.

4. visual comparison. Turn 8. Visual comparison anchors the discussion in observable features rather than assuming a style label has one identical interpretation everywhere.

5. bulk. Turn 10. Bulk refers to perceived fullness or weight in an area, here specifically near the collar rather than across the entire head.

6. styling routine. Turn 12. Styling routine describes the time and effort Morgan normally uses, which informs consultation without guaranteeing a particular result.

7. upkeep. Turn 14. Upkeep covers ongoing effort needed to maintain an appearance; it remains a discussion rather than an established five-minute guarantee.

8. growth pattern. Turn 16. Growth pattern is the direction or arrangement of natural hair growth, which must be assessed on the client rather than inferred from another person's photo.

9. appearance. Turn 18. Appearance describes the visible direction being discussed, without claiming an exact length or technical cutting method has already been agreed.

10. time budget. Turn 20. Time budget records Morgan's available styling time, not a promise that the proposed appearance will always take exactly five minutes.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. C

Barber: "The client prefers photo C."

C is the reference with the covered-side appearance the client chooses.

2. nape

Client: "The unwanted fullness is at the nape."

Nape identifies the specific location of the fullness concern.

3. ten

Barber: "The daily time budget is ten minutes."

Ten minutes is the reported allowance, not a guaranteed styling duration.

4. method

Client: "No cutting method has been agreed."

The brief leaves the technical method open despite the appearance preference.

03 Briefing and language checks

Discussing color without promising a photograph

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What is booked today?

B. A consultation only

Today's booking is explicitly a consultation, not a color-service appointment.

2. Which history detail remains unknown?

A. The previous home-color product

Priya cannot identify the earlier product, so its identity remains unknown.

3. Which claim is unsupported?

B. The photographed result will be completed by Friday.

Neither suitability nor time has been established to support that deadline promise.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which explanation distinguishes level and tone?

D. Level is lightness or darkness; tone is color character.

The correct explanation separates two different dimensions of color description.

2. Which history entry is accurate?

A. Previous home-color product not identified.

The client reports prior use but cannot identify the product or category.

3. Which response handles the deadline accurately?

A. I understand Friday matters; we have not assessed whether that is achievable.

The response acknowledges the preference without replacing the pending assessment with a promise.

4. Which status should reception receive?

A. Consultation only; no color appointment booked.

The supplied facts establish only the consultation and an unbooked future service.

03 Conversation answers

Discussing color without promising a photograph

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. color consultation. Turn 2. Color consultation identifies today's booked discussion and assessment, not an appointment to perform the requested color service.

2. Tone. Turn 4. Tone describes the warm or cool character Priya likes, rather than the separate question of how light the color is.

3. level. Turn 6. Level refers to relative lightness or darkness, which remains a separate preference to clarify alongside the cool tone.

4. home color. Turn 8. Home color identifies the reported earlier product use without inventing its exact brand, category, or effects.

5. product identity. Turn 10. Product identity means the actual identifying information, which is more useful than guessing the category from a remembered package color.

6. Suitability. Turn 12. Suitability is whether the proposed service is appropriate after assessment; it has not been established by the reference or deadline.

7. service duration. Turn 14. Service duration is the time needed for the proposed service, which remains unassessed rather than guaranteed to fit before Friday.

8. cost. Turn 16. Cost has not been assessed because the service plan is not established; no quoted total is available from the supplied facts.

9. color goal. Turn 18. Color goal captures the desired cool-tone appearance without turning it into a selected formula, accepted price, or booked service.

10. booking status. Turn 20. Booking status distinguishes today's consultation from a future color appointment, which remains unbooked despite the client's preferred deadline.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. warmer

Colorist: "The requested tonal direction is warmer."

Warmer describes the desired color character in this new request.

2. unidentified

Client: "My previous product remains unidentified."

The product was used but its identity is still unknown.

3. consultation

Colorist: "Today is a consultation only."

The appointment covers discussion rather than an approved color service.

4. booked

Reception: "No future service is booked."

A desired result and event do not create a confirmed appointment.

04 Briefing and language checks

Booking time and handling appointment changes

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is the revised start based on the stated delay?

D. 2:20

Twenty minutes after the original 2:00 appointment gives a 2:20 start.

2. When would the ordinary forty-minute service finish?

A. 3:00

Adding forty minutes to 2:20 gives an ordinary finish of 3:00.

3. Which replacement does Luis choose?

C. Tomorrow at 10:00

The client chooses the available 10:00 appointment tomorrow as the replacement.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which explanation is accurate?

B. Starting at 2:20 would ordinarily finish at 3:00, after your departure deadline.

The calculation preserves the ordinary duration and shows the fifteen-minute conflict.

2. Why is the change fee waived here?

C. The salon's delay causes the rescheduling under its stated policy.

The brief gives a specific local policy and a salon-caused delay.

3. Which booking record is correct after acceptance?

D. Tomorrow 10:00 replaces today's appointment.

The accepted option is a replacement, not a second active appointment.

4. Which response should be avoided?

C. We will definitely compress the forty-minute service into twenty-five minutes.

No shortened service has been promised or established as feasible.

04 Conversation answers

Booking time and handling appointment changes

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. delay. Turn 2. Delay is the difference between the original 2:00 start and the revised 2:20 start, not the length of the haircut itself.

2. revised start. Turn 4. Revised start identifies 2:20 as the updated beginning, while the ordinary forty-minute service still has to follow.

3. service duration. Turn 6. Service duration is forty minutes; adding it to the revised 2:20 start produces a 3:00 ordinary finish.

4. departure deadline. Turn 8. Departure deadline is Luis's fixed latest leaving time of 2:45, which the ordinary revised schedule cannot meet.

5. availability. Turn 10. Availability means the 10:00 slot tomorrow can currently be offered; it becomes the replacement only after Luis chooses and confirms it.

6. fee waiver. Turn 12. Fee waiver means the salon does not charge the change fee in this salon-caused rescheduling; it is not a refund or universal rule.

7. replacement booking. Turn 14. Replacement booking means tomorrow's accepted appointment takes the place of today's slot rather than adding another active haircut booking.

8. booking record. Turn 16. Booking record holds the active appointment and change reason; updating it helps avoid conflicting reminders or duplicate active slots.

9. confirmation message. Turn 18. Confirmation message should state the actual date, 10:00 time, and haircut service so the client can verify the replacement details.

10. duplicate booking. Turn 20. Duplicate booking would leave two unintended active appointments; the accepted tomorrow slot replaces today's delayed appointment.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 2:00

Reception: "The ordinary finish would be 2:00."

Forty-five minutes after 1:15 gives an ordinary finish of 2:00.

2. ten

Client: "That is ten minutes after my departure deadline."

The ordinary 2:00 finish is ten minutes later than 1:50.

3. 9:30

Reception: "Tomorrow's replacement is at 9:30."

The client accepts the specific 9:30 alternative supplied in the brief.

4. waived

Reception: "The change fee is waived."

The stated policy removes this fee because the salon caused the delay.

05 Briefing and language checks

Checking comfort and pausing clearly

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What has not started?

B. The water and wash

The brief places the concern before water begins and before the wash starts.

2. Where does Sam describe pressure?

C. At the back of the neck against the support

Sam identifies the contact area at the back of the neck.

3. What does Sam agree to?

D. A comfort check, not starting the wash

Consent is limited to the check; preparation remains paused.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which report is factual?

A. Sam describes pressure at the back of the neck against the support.

The correct statement preserves the client's reported sensation without assigning cause or diagnosis.

2. Which action is agreed?

A. Ask Noor for a comfort check while preparation stays paused.

The client consents to review only, with no agreement to start washing.

3. Which reassurance overreaches?

B. This is definitely harmless, so we can carry on.

Harmlessness is not established, and the client has not agreed to continue.

4. Which chronology is accurate?

A. Discomfort was reported before water started.

The supplied sequence places the concern before water or washing begins.

05 Conversation answers

Checking comfort and pausing clearly

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. preparation. Turn 2. Preparation stopped before any water or washing began, so the sequence must stay accurate.

2. discomfort. Turn 4. Discomfort is the sensation Sam reported, not proof of a particular injury or cause.

3. lead stylist. Turn 6. Noor is the colleague arranging this salon review, not a substitute for medical or emergency care.

4. contact point. Turn 8. The contact point locates the pressure where the neck met the support.

5. client report. Turn 10. The client report preserves Sam's own description without adding an unsupported explanation.

6. water. Turn 12. Water never started, so temperature cannot be invented as an observed cause.

7. comfort check. Turn 14. The comfort check is a review, not permission to carry out the wash.

8. consent. Turn 16. Consent concerns a specific next action; improvement alone is not permission to proceed.

9. resume. Turn 18. Resume refers to paused preparation; the wash itself has not begun at all.

10. agreed next step. Turn 20. Sam accepts the review only, while preparation remains paused and washing has not begun.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. pressure

Assistant: "The reported sensation is pressure."

Pressure is the client's description, not an inferred injury or diagnosis.

2. started

Client: "The water has not started."

The concern occurs before water begins, preserving the correct chronology.

3. review

Assistant: "The agreed next step is a comfort review."

Review is the action accepted by the client in this scenario.

4. resume

Client: "I have not agreed to resume."

Agreement to review does not authorize restarting the paused wash.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Explaining services, prices, and product choices

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is the haircut-only total?

A. \$45

The supplied menu sets the haircut alone at forty-five dollars.

2. What is the complete combined total?

B. \$60

The forty-five-dollar haircut plus the fifteen-dollar optional finish totals sixty dollars.

3. What does Aisha choose?

D. Haircut only, with no finish or product added

The final choice explicitly excludes the optional finish and retail product.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which comparison is complete?

D. Haircut only \$45; haircut plus finish \$60.

The correct comparison gives both complete totals using the supplied menu.

2. Which question preserves a real choice?

C. Would you like the \$60 combined option or the \$45 haircut only?

The question presents both priced options before any service begins.

3. What does matte describe here?

D. A lower-shine appearance

Matte concerns appearance, not safety guarantees, purchase requirements, or haircut length.

4. Which final read-back matches Aisha's decision?

A. Haircut at \$45, with no finish or retail product added.

The correct read-back preserves the selected base service and explicit exclusions.

06 Conversation answers

Explaining services, prices, and product choices

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. service menu. Turn 2. Service menu is the specific list governing this fictional price comparison; the client should not be expected to infer its inclusions from other salons.

2. combined total. Turn 4. Combined total adds the forty-five-dollar haircut and fifteen-dollar finish, giving sixty dollars with no other charges in the exercise.

3. optional finish. Turn 6. Optional finish is a separate service the client may accept or decline; it is not automatically authorized by choosing the haircut.

4. base service. Turn 8. Base service is the haircut alone at forty-five dollars, which remains available without the optional finish.

5. retail product. Turn 10. Retail product is a separate take-home purchase, not a required component of either quoted service choice in this scenario.

6. product recommendation. Turn 12. Product recommendation is a suggestion to discuss, not the client's authorization to buy or a condition of receiving the stated service.

7. matte finish. Turn 14. Matte finish describes a lower-shine appearance, not the degree of hold or a guarantee that a product suits every client.

8. purchase decision. Turn 16. Purchase decision belongs to the client and remains separate from asking questions or hearing a recommendation.

9. service authorization. Turn 18. Service authorization is limited to the haircut the client selects; it excludes the optional finish and any retail purchase.

10. charge confirmation. Turn 20. Charge confirmation repeats the agreed forty-five-dollar haircut and exclusions, resolving the original misunderstanding before work starts.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. seventy

Stylist: "Both services would total seventy dollars."

Fifty plus twenty gives the combined total of seventy dollars.

2. fifty

Client: "My haircut-only choice is fifty dollars."

The selected base service retains its fifty-dollar price without the finish.

3. optional

Stylist: "The finish is optional."

The client can decline the separately priced finish in this menu.

4. selected

Client: "No retail product is selected."

The client explicitly declines a product rather than authorizing an extra sale.

07 Briefing and language checks

Responding to a concern about the result

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What does Mei report?

A. The left side looks longer

The concern is a reported visual difference that has not yet been reviewed.

2. What was the earlier agreed expectation?

B. An even outline

The consultation reportedly promised an even outline, making that expectation relevant to review.

3. What is accepted now?

B. A mirror review with Jo

Mei accepts the review while correction and payment decisions remain unapproved.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which opening is most useful?

B. I hear that the left side looks longer and that you expected an even outline.

The response acknowledges the specific concern and expectation without deciding cause or remedy.

2. Which statement confuses review with consent?

D. Agreeing to the mirror review means we can cut more without asking.

Consent to examine the result does not authorize additional cutting.

3. Which handover is accurate?

C. Client reports a longer-looking left side; joint review pending.

The handover preserves the reported appearance and unfinished review status.

4. Which next step has been accepted?

C. Mirror review with Jo before deciding a remedy

The brief confirms review only and leaves both correction and refund unapproved.

07 Conversation answers

Responding to a concern about the result

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. pause checkout. Turn 2. Pausing checkout stops the payment process temporarily; it does not decide the complaint or refund.

2. mirror review. Turn 4. A mirror review lets Mei show Jo the specific area before a remedy is proposed.

3. even outline. Turn 6. The even outline was the reported consultation expectation, not a new style request.

4. consultation note. Turn 8. The consultation note helps compare the earlier plan with Mei's concern without pre-deciding the finding.

5. cause. Turn 10. The cause remains unknown until the relevant review; the receptionist should not invent it.

6. permission to cut. Turn 12. Permission to review the result does not authorize additional cutting without a separate agreement.

7. refund request. Turn 14. A refund request can be raised through the salon process but has not been approved here.

8. reported concern. Turn 16. The reported concern is that the client's left side looks longer, not that an error is already confirmed.

9. correction. Turn 18. A correction would be additional work; no particular correction has been proposed and accepted yet.

10. pending. Turn 20. Pending means the accepted review has not yet occurred; the concern is not recorded as resolved.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. right

Reception: "The reported concern is the right side."

The client identifies the right side in this new scenario.

2. even

Client: "We agreed on an even outline."

Even outline is the earlier expectation relevant to the review.

3. review

Reception: "The accepted next step is a mirror review."

Review is accepted, while a particular remedy has not been authorized.

4. approved

Reception: "No refund is approved."

Pausing checkout and reviewing the concern do not establish refund approval.

08 Briefing and language checks

Passing preferences to the next appointment

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What future service is requested?

B. A color consultation, not yet booked

The client requested a consultation but has not selected or accepted an appointment.

2. Which preferences are confirmed?

C. Retained front length and no finishing spray

The brief confirms only the two stated service preferences.

3. What is the photography status?

C. No promotional-photo agreement is recorded

No explicit agreement has been recorded, so permission must not be assumed.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Retain front length; no spray; color consultation requested but unbooked.

The correct handover preserves both confirmed preferences and the unbooked request.

2. What does no promotional-photo agreement recorded mean?

C. Do not treat promotional use as authorized.

Absence of a recorded agreement does not supply permission for promotional use.

3. Which label should replace an inaccurate booked entry?

C. Requested, not booked

Requested reflects the client's interest without inventing an accepted date.

4. Which read-back catches a meaningful error?

C. No date accepted; the consultation remains unbooked.

The specific read-back verifies the unresolved booking status rather than offering a vague acknowledgment.

08 Conversation answers

Passing preferences to the next appointment

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. client profile. Turn 2. The client profile holds the relevant preferences and requests, rather than a new confirmed booking.

2. retain. Turn 4. Retain means keep the front length, the opposite of cutting it shorter.

3. no-spray preference. Turn 6. This preference records the explicit product exclusion, without authorizing a substitute.

4. consultation request. Turn 8. The request concerns a future discussion, not an accepted color service or appointment.

5. unbooked. Turn 10. Unbooked is accurate because no appointment date has been offered and accepted.

6. Service consent. Turn 12. Permission for the salon service does not itself authorize promotional photographs or their publication.

7. recorded. Turn 14. Recorded refers to documented agreement; its absence cannot be replaced by an assumption.

8. read-back. Turn 16. A read-back repeats the actual choices and statuses so a colleague can catch changed meaning.

9. booking status. Turn 18. Booking status remains separate from confirmed preferences, so an enquiry cannot become a booking by accident.

10. follow-up contact. Turn 20. Follow-up contact is the next availability conversation, not an assertion that an appointment already exists.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. side

Stylist: "Please retain the side length."

The confirmed retained-length preference concerns the sides in this new case.

2. unbooked

Reception: "The consultation is requested but unbooked."

No accepted appointment has been established by the request alone.

3. reception

Stylist: "The next availability discussion belongs to reception."

Reception is explicitly assigned the next contact in the supplied handover.

4. recorded

Reception: "No promotional-image agreement is recorded."

The record contains no agreement authorizing promotional image use.

08

09 Conversation answers

Length in the way you wear it

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. dry outline. Turn 2. The dry outline is the visible shoulder-level shape Nia wants to retain, not the longer stretched endpoint.

2. shrinkage. Turn 4. Shrinkage describes the shorter visible length when curls recoil, not missing hair or a measured amount to cut.

3. crown volume. Turn 6. Crown volume concerns fullness at the upper back of the head, separate from the retained outer length.

4. Strand thickness. Turn 8. Strand thickness describes individual hairs; fine strands can occur in a head with many hairs.

5. density. Turn 10. Density concerns the amount of hair in an area, not the diameter of each strand or a product instruction.

6. natural fall. Turn 12. Natural fall is how the hair sits without being held stretched, which is the relevant appearance for this request.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. chin

Client: Keep the dry outline at my chin .

The selected endpoint is the chin in the dry unstretched state, not the stretched collarbone position.

2. stretched

Stylist: The longer comparison shows the hair stretched .

The collarbone endpoint belongs to the stretched comparison, not the requested natural outline.

3. coarse

Client: The individual strands are coarse .

Coarse describes individual strand thickness, not how many hairs grow in an area.

4. low

Stylist: The recorded density is low .

Low density concerns the amount of hair in an area and can coexist with coarse strands.

Background reading: [Wella Professionals: curl patterns and visible shrinkage](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

A number needs a length

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. number two. Turn 2. Number two corresponds to a nominal 6 mm length on this specified chart, not removal of 2 mm.

2. left. Turn 4. Left means retained after cutting, whereas Pavel initially understood the number as an amount removed.

3. number four. Turn 6. The supplied chart assigns 13 mm to number four; the number is not a centimeter measurement.

4. millimeters. Turn 8. The millimeter labels provide the actual nominal lengths; guard numbers are identifiers rather than a one-millimeter scale.

5. guide comb. Turn 10. The guide comb and its own documentation identify the length; another trimmer need not use the same numbering.

6. separate agreement. Turn 14. A side-length preference does not settle the top, neckline, or beard, which are expressly unagreed.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. ten

Client: I want approximately ten millimeters remaining at the sides.

Ten millimeters is the requested retained length, not the amount removed.

2. three

Barber: On this chart, that is guard number three .

Number three corresponds to 10 mm on the supplied tool-specific chart.

3. removed

Client: The chart describes length left, not length removed .

Remaining length and the amount taken off are different measurements.

4. unagreed

Barber: Work on the beard is still unagreed .

A side-length request does not authorize a separate, undiscussed beard service.

10

Background reading: Wahl: guide-comb lengths and adjustable clipper terminology. The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Read the color record precisely

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. level. Turn 2. Level seven describes lightness or darkness here; it does not establish the desired cool tonal character.

2. tone. Turn 4. Tone distinguishes the warm observed sample from the cool target even though both are described at level seven.

3. Regrowth. Turn 6. Regrowth identifies the naturally grown root area, which is recorded separately from the previously colored lengths.

4. previously colored lengths. Turn 8. The longer previously colored area has its own starting record; it cannot be merged with the natural regrowth entry.

5. strand test. Turn 10. A strand test supplies information about the tested hair sample; it is not a whole-head guarantee or a skin allergy assessment.

6. allergy-alert assessment. Turn 12. The allergy-alert assessment is a separate incomplete requirement; an acceptable-looking hair sample does not replace it.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. six

Client: The sample and goal share level six .

Both entries state level six, so their difference is tonal rather than the supplied level.

2. neutral

Colorist: The requested tone is neutral .

Neutral is the goal; warm is the recorded sample result.

3. warm

Client: The sample is still described as warm .

The observed warm tone must remain in the record rather than being replaced by the desired tone.

4. incomplete

Colorist: The allergy-alert assessment is incomplete .

The hair-sample result does not complete the separate outstanding assessment or authorize application.

11

Background reading: [Wella: distinct purposes of skin-allergy and hair-strand assessments](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Turning a reference photo into a clear request

Open the reference: Which features of this photograph do you like?

Ask about daily use: Do you need to be able to tie it back?

Record the exclusion: No fringe is requested.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Describing shape, texture, and everyday styling

Name the priority: You want less fullness at the neckline.

Describe the contrast: Photo B exposes skin in its shortest area.

Record the time limit: You have about five minutes each morning.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Discussing color without promising a photograph

Clarify the attraction: Is it the cool tone or the lighter level that you like?

Set today's scope: Today is a consultation only.

Acknowledge the deadline: I understand you would prefer it before Friday.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Booking time and handling appointment changes

Acknowledge the delay: I am sorry; your appointment is running twenty minutes late.

State the ordinary duration: We normally allow forty minutes for this service.

Offer a concrete alternative: We have 10:00 tomorrow available.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Checking comfort and pausing clearly

Acknowledge promptly: Thank you for telling me; we will pause here.

Use the client's description: You feel pressure where your neck meets the support.

Name the next person: Noor is the lead stylist handling this check.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Explaining services, prices, and product choices

Acknowledge the expectation: I understand you thought the finish was included.

State the combined total: Both services together would be \$60.

Separate recommendation and sale: A product recommendation does not add it to your purchase.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Responding to a concern about the result

Acknowledge specifically: I hear that the left side looks longer to you.

Avoid dismissal: I will not assume it is just your imagination.

Preserve the wording: I will pass on that it looks longer, not that a cause is confirmed.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Passing preferences to the next appointment

Open the handover: I have two confirmed preferences and one unbooked request.

Name the requested service: The client requested a future color consultation.

State the record accurately: No promotional-photo agreement is recorded.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

accepted date confirm the accepted date	68
acknowledgment give a specific acknowledgment	60
add-on confirm an add-on	50
agreed next step state the agreed next step	42
agreed plan repeat the agreed plan	6
apparent difference describe the apparent difference	59
appointment slot confirm the appointment slot	32
ash discuss an ash tone	23
assessment finding distinguish an assessment finding	59
availability check tomorrow's availability	32
back length confirm back length	6
balayage clarify balayage expectations	24
banding describe the color banding	24
bangs explain bangs	5
base color clarify the base color	23
base service identify the base service	50
basin refer to the basin	41
blend discuss the blend	14
blunt outline describe a blunt outline	6
bob clarify the bob outline	5
booking record update the booking record	33
bulk clarify unwanted bulk	14
calendar date confirm the calendar date	33
cancellation record the cancellation	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

cause avoid inventing a cause	60
change fee explain the change fee	33
charge confirmation give a charge confirmation	51
checkout pause confirm the checkout pause	60
chin length distinguish chin length	5
client perspective confirm the client perspective	59
client profile update the client profile	68
client report preserve the client report	41
collarbone length confirm collarbone length	5
color consultation book a color consultation	23
color goal clarify the color goal	23
color history review color history	23
combined total state the combined total	50
comfort check arrange a comfort check	41
confirmation message send a confirmation message	33
consent confirm service consent	6
consent to continue ask for consent to continue	41
consultation conduct a consultation	5
consultation note check the consultation note	59
consultation request record the consultation request	68
contact point identify the contact point	41
cool tone identify a cool tone	23
correction discuss a proposed correction	60
coverage retain side coverage	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

cowlick identify a cowlick	15
crown identify the crown	15
current record verify the current record	69
defensive response avoid a defensive response	60
delay explain the delay	32
demi-permanent color clarify demi-permanent color	24
density assess hair density	15
departure deadline respect the departure deadline	32
discomfort acknowledge discomfort	41
duplicate booking avoid a duplicate booking	33
estimated finish calculate the estimated finish	32
even outline review the even outline	59
exposed skin avoid exposed skin	14
face-framing discuss face-framing	6
factual handover provide a factual handover	69
fade compare fade references	14
fee waiver apply the fee waiver	33
finish compare the finish	15
finishing spray discuss finishing spray	51
follow-up contact arrange follow-up contact	68
fringe clarify the fringe	5
front length protect front length	6
front-length retention confirm front-length retention	68
fullness reduce neckline fullness	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

gel describe a gel	51
golden identify golden tones	23
growth pattern discuss the growth pattern	15
guide comb check the guide-comb length	15
hairline describe the hairline	15
hand mirror offer a hand mirror	59
handover give an accurate handover	68
highlights discuss highlights	24
hold compare hold descriptions	51
home color identify previous home color	23
image permission check image permission	69
inclusive price clarify the inclusive price	50
intensity clarify reported intensity	42
intermittent describe intermittent pressure	42
itemized price provide an itemized price	50
late arrival distinguish a late arrival	33
layers discuss layers	6
lead stylist contact the lead stylist	42
left side identify the left side	59
length removal confirm length removal	6
level discuss the color level	23
lightener discuss a lightener service	24
location clarify the location	42
low ponytail retain low-ponytail length	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

low taper clarify the low taper	14
matte finish clarify a matte finish	51
mirror review arrange a mirror review	59
mousse identify a mousse	51
nape identify the nape	14
natural texture discuss natural texture	15
neck support check the neck support	41
neckline discuss the neckline	14
next contact owner identify the next contact owner	69
no-show clarify the no-show category	33
no-spray preference record the no-spray preference	68
notice period explain the notice period	33
onset ask about onset	42
open request track the open request	69
optional finish explain the optional finish	50
outline confirm the outline	5
parting identify the parting	6
pause keep preparation paused	41
pending booking distinguish a pending booking	68
perimeter discuss the perimeter	5
permanent color distinguish permanent color	24
permission scope confirm permission scope	69
persistent describe persistent discomfort	42
pomade clarify a pomade preference	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

portfolio image discuss a portfolio image	69
positioning refer a positioning concern	42
preference note preserve a preference note	68
premature conclusion avoid a premature conclusion	60
preparation pause preparation	41
pressure describe the pressure	41
price misunderstanding resolve a price misunderstanding	51
product claim check a product claim	51
product recommendation separate a recommendation from a sale	50
promotional use clarify promotional use	69
publication channel specify a publication channel	69
purchase decision confirm the purchase decision	51
read-back perform a read-back	68
reassurance offer measured reassurance	42
record amendment make a record amendment	68
recorded agreement check the recorded agreement	69
reference photo discuss the reference photo	5
refund approval distinguish refund approval	60
refund request record a refund request	60
regrowth discuss visible regrowth	23
remedy clarify the proposed remedy	60
replacement booking confirm the replacement booking	32
reported expectation record the reported expectation	59
reschedule reschedule the haircut	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

resolution status state the resolution status	60
result concern acknowledge a result concern	59
resume confirm before resuming	41
retail product discuss a retail product	50
retained length preserve retained length	5
revised start confirm the revised start	32
rework consent confirm rework consent	60
right side compare the right side	59
salon-caused delay acknowledge the salon-caused delay	33
scalp distinguish scalp from neck	42
scheduled start state the scheduled start	32
semi-permanent color discuss semi-permanent color	24
sensitivity record reported sensitivity	42
service allocation preserve the service allocation	33
service authorization confirm service authorization	51
service consent distinguish service consent	68
service duration state the service duration	32
service estimate provide a service estimate	24
service exclusion explain service exclusions	50
service inclusion clarify service inclusions	50
service menu explain the service menu	50
service record review the service record	60
shine describe the shine	51
shrinkage allow for visible shrinkage	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

side length compare side length	6
sideburn clarify sideburn length	15
skin fade identify the skin fade	14
status label use a precise status label	69
straight fringe identify the straight fringe	5
strand test review the strand-test result	24
strand thickness distinguish strand thickness	15
styling cream describe a styling cream	50
styling routine describe the styling routine	15
suitability assess service suitability	24
support adjustment request a support adjustment review	42
taper discuss a taper	14
temporary color identify temporary color	24
time conflict identify the time conflict	32
tone clarify the tone	23
toner clarify a toner service	24
transition describe the transition	14
trim clarify the trim	6
unconfirmed assumption remove an unconfirmed assumption	69
upkeep discuss upkeep	15
viewing angle clarify the viewing angle	59
waitlist explain the waitlist	33
warm tone describe a warm tone	23
wash station identify the wash station	41

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Barbers, Hairstylists, and Cosmetologists.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for consultations, service records, styling, payment, and client communication. The original cases are not transcripts of real appointments. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] US Food and Drug Administration. Cosmetics Safety Q&A: Hair Dyes.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for the importance of current warnings, instructions, and required checks. This book gives no dye formulas, testing steps, or treatment advice. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Wella. Hair Levels and Tones.

[Open the original source](#)

Manufacturer terminology distinguishing lightness or darkness from warm or cool tonal character. No brand numbering system or product recommendation is taught. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Hair Salons.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for checking actual salon-product information and hazards rather than relying on a familiar product name or marketing claim. Checked 10 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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